

An Expression A Day

AEAD PDF Book

No. 301-400 / 100 entries

Hilofumi Yamamoto, Ph.D.

Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)

Plenty of

たっぷり

Tappuri

Plenty of

Variants

- たっぷり
plenty of
- 時間がたっぷりある
have plenty of time
- たっぷり使える
can use it generously

Adjusted Expression

きょう じゅう つか じかん じゅうぶん
今日は、自由に使える時間が十分にあるので、うれしいです。

I am happy because I have enough time today that I can use freely.

Example

きょう じゅう じかん
今日は、自由な時間がたっぷりあってうれしい。

I'm happy because I have plenty of free time today.

Notes

"Tappuri" is a word used to express an abundant amount of something, such as time, space, or resources. It means "plenty of" or "a generous amount of." This expression is commonly used to indicate that something is available in a sufficient or generous amount. The difference between

"tappuri" and "takusan" is that "tappuri" implies not just a large quantity, but also that the amount is sufficient and can be fully utilized.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expressing that there is enough of something
- expressing a state with room to spare
- showing satisfaction with abundance

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- adverb
- colloquial
- quantity expression
- room to spare
- satisfaction

For now

いま
今のところ、

Ima no tokoro,

For now

Variants

- 今のところ
for now
- 今のところは
at the moment
- 今のところ問題ありません
so far

Adjusted Expression

げんざい は け さ よ ほう あめ
現在は晴れていますが、今朝の予報では雨になるとされています。

At present, it is sunny, but this morning's forecast says that it will rain.

Example

いま は け さ よ ほう あめ
今のところ、晴れてるけど、今朝の予報では雨。

For now, it's sunny, but the forecast this morning said it would rain.

Notes

"Ima no tokoro" is a phrase used to indicate the current situation or status at a specific point in time, often with the implication that the

situation may change later. The word "ima" means "now," "no" is a particle that indicates association, and "tokoro" means "point" or "place."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expressing the current situation
- implying that things may change later
- presenting a temporary judgment

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- adverbial expression
- colloquial
- time expression
- current situation
- provisionality

Do you want a little?

すこ
少しほしい？

Sukoshi hoshii?

Do you want a little?

Variants

- 少しほしい？
do you want a little?
- コーヒー、少しほしい？
do you want a little coffee?
- 少しいりますか？
would you like a little?

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{こーひー}コーヒーを^{すこ}少し^のお飲みになりますか」 B 「いいえ、^{けっこう}結構です。ありがとうございます」

A: Would you like a little coffee? B: No, thank you. I am fine.

Example

A 「^{こーひー}コーヒー、^{すこ}少しほしい？」 B 「いいえ、^{だいじょうぶ}大丈夫です」

A: Do you want a little coffee? B: No, I'm good.

Notes

"Sukoshi hoshii?" is a phrase used to ask if someone wants a small amount of something, such as food, drink, or assistance. The word

"sukoshi" means "a little" or "a few," and "hoshii" is an i-adjective that means "want."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- offering a small amount
- asking what the other person wants
- offering food or drink

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- question expression
- offer
- eating and drinking situation
- considerate expression

Did you hear that?

いま き
今の聞こえた？

Ima no kikoeta?

Did you hear that?

Variants

- 今の聞こえた？
did you hear that?
- 今の音、聞こえた？
did you hear that sound just now?
- 何か聞こえた？
did you hear something?

Adjusted Expression

A 「先ほどのドアの音は聞こえましたか」 B 「はい、誰かが入ってきたようです」

A: Did you hear the sound of the door just now? B: Yes, it seems that someone came in.

Example

A 「ドアの音、今の聞こえた？」 B 「うん、何かが入ってきたみたい」

A: Did you hear the sound of the door just now? B: Yeah, it seems like someone came in.

Notes

"Ima no kikoeta?" is a phrase used to ask if someone heard a sound or noise that occurred just now. The word "ima" means "now," and "kikoeta" is the past tense of the verb "kikoeru" (to hear). The difference between "kiku" and "kikoeru" is that "kiku" refers to actively listening, while "kikoeru" refers to hearing something as an auditory phenomenon. Since "kikoeru" already expresses audibility, it does not normally form a separate potential form. Therefore, the negative form is "kikoenai."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

reacting to a sound just heard

checking whether the other person heard it too

sharing awareness of something unusual

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

question expression

hearing expression

confirmation

unusual event

Don't make a noise

おと た
音を立てないで

Oto o tatenaide

Don't make a noise

Variants

- 音を立てないで
don't make a noise
- 静かにして
please be quiet
- 今、音を立てないで
don't make any noise right now

Adjusted Expression

いま ろくが 今、録画していますので、できるだけ静かにしてください。

I am recording now, so please be as quiet as possible.

Example

いま ろくが おと た
今、録画しているから、音を立てないで。

I'm recording now, so don't make a noise.

Notes

"Oto o tatenaide" is a phrase used to ask someone not to make a sound or noise. The word "oto" means "sound" or "noise," "o" is a particle that

marks the object of the verb, and "tatenaide" is the negative te-form of the verb "tateru" (to make or raise).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- asking someone not to make noise
- warning during recording
- softly stopping someone's action

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- request expression
- prohibition expression
- sound
- recording

Let's hurry

いそ
急ぎましょう

Isogimashou

Let's hurry

Variants

- 急ぎましょう
let's hurry
- 少し急ぎましょう
let's hurry a little
- 急いだ方がよさそうです
it looks like we should hurry

Adjusted Expression

よてい じかん すこ いそ すす
予定より時間がかかっていますので、ここからは少し急いで進めましょう。

Since this has taken longer than planned, let's proceed a little more quickly from here.

Example

じかん か いそ
時間が掛かってしまいましたね。急ぎましょう。

It took longer than expected. Let's hurry.

Notes

"Isogimashou" is a phrase used to suggest that someone should hurry or move quickly. The word "isogu" means "to hurry" or "to rush," and "mashou" is a phrase that means "let's" or "shall we."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

encouraging someone to hurry

sharing that there is not enough time

suggesting that people move faster together

Tags EN

immediate grammar

polite expression

suggestion expression

time expression

hurry

encouraging action

Anytime is fine

いつでもいいですよ

Itsudemo ii desu yo

Anytime is fine

Variants

- いつでもいいですよ
anytime is fine
- いつでも大丈夫です
anytime works for me
- ご都合のよい時間で大丈夫です
whatever time is convenient for you is fine

Adjusted Expression

A 「明日^{あした}の会議^{かいぎ}は、午後^{ごご}でも差し支え^{さしつか}ありませんか」 B 「はい、私^{わたし}はどの
時間帯^{じかんたい}でも対応^{たいおう}できます」

A: Would it be all right to hold the meeting tomorrow afternoon? B: Yes, I can accommodate any time slot.

Example

A 「明日^{あした}、会議^{かいぎ}は午後^{ごご}でも大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}ですか？」 B 「はい、いつでもいいですよ」

A: Is it okay to have the meeting in the afternoon tomorrow? B: Yes, anytime is fine.

Notes

"Itsudemo ii desu yo" is a phrase used to indicate that something is acceptable or convenient at any time. The word "itsudemo" means "anytime" or "whenever," "ii" means "good" or "fine," "desu" is a polite form of the copula "da" (to be), and "yo" is a particle that emphasizes the statement.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

leaving the time to the other person

expressing that any time is convenient

responding flexibly to scheduling

Tags EN

immediate grammar

polite expression

response expression

scheduling

convenience

considerate expression

What the heck!

なに
それ何!

Sore nani!

What the heck!

Variants

- それ何!
what the heck!
- それ何?
what is that?
- 何それ!
what's that about?

Adjusted Expression

A 「昨日、^{きのう}彼、^{かれ}突然、^{とつぜん}辞めた^やそうです」 B 「それはどういうことですか」

A: I heard that he suddenly quit yesterday. B: What does that mean?

Example

A 「昨日、^{きのう}彼、^{かれ}突然、^{とつぜん}辞めた^やんだって」 B 「それ^{なに}何!」

A: I heard he suddenly quit yesterday. B: What the heck!

Notes

"Sore nani!" is a phrase used to express surprise, disbelief, or shock about something unexpected or unusual. The word "sore" means "that," and "nani" means "what." The exclamation mark emphasizes the

speaker's strong reaction. Of course, in a normal context, it can also mean "What is that?"

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- reacting to unexpected news
- expressing surprise or disbelief
- immediate reaction to someone's statement

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- response expression
- surprise
- disbelief
- exclamatory expression

Who are you waiting for?

だれ^{だれ}を^を待^まっているの？

Dare o matte iru no?

Who are you waiting for?

Variants

- 誰を待っているの？
who are you waiting for?
- 誰待ってるの？
who are you waiting on?
- 誰を待っていますか？
whom are you waiting for?

Adjusted Expression

A 「どなたを^まお待ちですか」 B 「友人^{ゆうじん}を^ま待っています」

A: Who are you waiting for? B: I am waiting for a friend.

Example

A 「誰^{だれ}を^ま待っているの？」 B 「友^{とも}だち」

A: Who are you waiting for? B: My friend.

Notes

"Dare o matte iru no?" is a phrase used to ask who someone is waiting for. The word "dare" means "who," "o" is a particle that marks the object of the verb, "matte iru" is the progressive form of the verb "matsu" (to

wait), and "no" is not possessive here but a soft sentence-final particle used when asking gently. In casual conversation, using "ka" after a plain form can sound blunt or rough, so "no" is often used instead. In more formal conversation, "desu ka" or "masu ka" is appropriate. The reason for using "o" in "dare o" is to distinguish the person being waited for from the person who is waiting. When the context makes the relation clear, particles may be omitted and the meaning can still be understood.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- asking who someone is waiting for
- soft casual question
- making the relation clear with a particle

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- question expression
- sentence-final particle
- particle omission
- object

If you need help, let me know

もし、^{てっだ}手伝ってほしいことがあったら^い言
ってね

Moshi, tetsudatte hoshii koto ga attara itte ne

If you need help, let me know

Variants

- もし、手伝ってほしいことがあったら言ってね
if you need help, let me know
- 手伝ってほしいことがあったら言ってね
let me know if there is anything you want me to help with
- 何か手伝えることがあったら言ってね
let me know if there is anything I can do

Adjusted Expression

A 「何か^{なに}お手伝い^{てっだ}できることがありましたら、お知らせ^しください」 B 「ありが
とうございます。今^{いま}のところは大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}です」

A: Please let me know if there is anything I can help with. B: Thank you. I
am fine for now.

Example

A 「もし、^{てっだ}手伝ってほしいことがあったら^い言ってね」 B 「ありがとう、今^{いま}の
ところ、大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}」

A: If you need help, let me know. B: Thank you, I'm good for now.

Notes

"Moshi, tetsudatte hoshii koto ga attara itte ne" is a phrase used to offer help or assistance to someone. The word "moshi" means "if," "tetsudatte" is the te-form of the verb "tetsudau" (to help), and "verb + te hoshii" means "want someone to do something." The phrase "koto ga attara" means "if there is something," and "itte ne" means "tell me" or "let me know."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

offering help

showing consideration for the other person

expressing that the other person may ask when needed

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

offer

considerate expression

support

conditional expression

Let's take a quick look

ちよっと^み見てみようよ

Chotto mite miyou yo

Let's take a quick look

Variants

- ちよっと見てみようよ
let's take a quick look
- 少し見てみよう
let's have a look
- とりあえず見てみよう
let's check it out for a moment

Adjusted Expression

A 「これは^{なん}何でしょうか」 B 「まず、^{すこ}少し^{かくにん}確認してみましょう」

A: What is this? B: First, let's check it briefly.

Example

A 「これ、^{なに}何？」 B 「ちよっと^み見てみようよ」

A: What's this? B: Let's take a quick look.

Notes

"Chotto mite miyou yo" is an expression used to suggest taking a quick look at something or checking something briefly. The word "chotto" means "a little" or "a bit," "mite" is the te-form of the verb "miru" (to see),

and "miyou" is the volitional form of "miru." The particle "yo" adds a casual sense of invitation or encouragement.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

suggesting a quick check

inviting the other person to look together

reacting to something unknown

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

suggestion expression

checking

invitation

trying

Can you fix this?

これ、^{なお}直せる？

Kore, naoseru?

Can you fix this?

Variants

- これ、直せる？
can you fix this?
- これ、修理できる？
can this be repaired?
- これ、直りますか？
is it possible to fix this?

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{けいたい}携帯が^{こわ}壊れてしまいました。これは^{しゅうり}修理できますか」 B 「はい、^{ひよう}費用をお
^{しはら}支払いいただければ、^{しゅうり}修理できます」

A: My phone has broken. Can this be repaired? B: Yes, it can be repaired if you pay the repair fee.

Example

A 「^{けいたい}携帯、^{こわ}壊れた。これ、^{なお}直せる？」 B 「^{なお}直せるよ」 A 「^{ほんとう}本当！」 B 「うん、お
^{かね}金を出せば」

A: My phone is broken. Can you fix this? B: I can. A: Really? B: Yes, if you pay.

Notes

"Kore, naoseru?" is used to ask if someone can fix something that is broken or damaged. The word "kore" means "this," and "naoseru" is the potential form of the verb "naosu" (to fix). The word "keitai" means "cell phone" or "mobile phone," and "kowareta" is the past tense of the verb "kowareru" (to break). The word "daseba" is the conditional form of the verb "dasu" (to put out, to pay in this context).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

asking whether something can be fixed

checking what can be done about something broken

checking someone's ability or possibility

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

question expression

potential expression

repair

joke

It happens

そんなこともあるよ

Sonna koto mo aru yo

It happens

Variants

- そんなこともあるよ
it happens
- そういうこともあるよ
that can happen
- まあ、そんなこともある
these things happen

Adjusted Expression

A 「実験^{じっけん}が失敗^{しっぱい}しました」 B 「実験^{じっけん}では、そのようなことが起こ^おることもあります」

A: The experiment failed. B: In experiments, things like that can happen.

Example

A 「実験^{じっけん}、失敗^{しっぱい}」 B 「そんなこともあるよ」

A: The experiment failed. B: It happens.

Notes

"Sonna koto mo aru yo" is a phrase used to express that something unwanted or unfortunate can happen in daily life. It is often used to help someone, or oneself, change feelings after a disappointment. The word

"sonna" means "such," "koto" means "thing," "mo" means "also," and "aru" means "to exist," but in this expression it means "can happen." The sentence-final particle "yo" presents the statement as something the listener may need to hear.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

comforting someone after a failure

letting an unfortunate event pass

helping someone shift their mood

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

response expression

comforting

acceptance

shifting one's mood

I have a class today

きょう じゅぎょう
今日は授業がある

Kyou wa jugyou ga aru

I have a class today

Variants

- 今日は授業がある
I have a class today
- 今日、授業ある？
do you have a class today?
- 午後から授業がある
I have a class from the afternoon

Adjusted Expression

A 「今日は授業がありますか」 B 「はい、午後から授業があります」

A: Do you have a class today? B: Yes, I have a class from the afternoon.

Example

A 「今日、授業ある？」 B 「うん、午後から」

A: Do you have a class today? B: Yes, in the afternoon.

Notes

"Kyou wa jugyou ga aru" is a phrase used to indicate that someone has a class or lesson on a particular day. The word "kyou" means "today," "wa" marks the topic of the sentence, "jugyou" means "class" or "lesson," "ga"

marks what exists, and "aru" means "to exist" or, in this context, "to have."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expressing whether one has a scheduled event
- checking a class schedule
- sharing one's schedule for the day

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- schedule expression
- class
- existence
- daily conversation

Hold on a second

ちょっと^ま待って

Chotto matte

Hold on a second

Variants

- ちょっと待って
hold on a second
- ちょっと待ってください
wait a moment
- 少し待ってもらえますか
could you wait a moment?

Adjusted Expression

すみません、今^{いま}、電話^{でんわ}をしていますので、少し^{すこ}お待ち^まいただけますか。

Excuse me, I am on the phone right now, so could you wait a moment?

Example

すみません、今^{いま}、電話^{でんわ}してるんで、ちょっと^ま待ってもらえますか？

Excuse me, I'm on the phone right now. Can you wait a moment?

Notes

"Chotto matte" is a phrase used to ask someone to wait for a moment. The word "chotto" means "a little" or "a bit," and "matte" is the te-form of the verb "matsu" (to wait).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

asking someone to wait briefly

temporarily stopping someone's action

sharing that one cannot respond immediately

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

request expression

asking someone to wait

phone call

considerate expression

I thought you weren't coming

こ おも
来ないのかと思った

Konai no ka to omotta

I thought you weren't coming

Variants

- 来ないのかと思った

I thought you weren't coming

- もう来ないのかと思った

I thought you might not come

- 来ないのかと思って心配した

I was worried that you weren't coming

Adjusted Expression

A 「遅^{おそ}かったですね」 B 「すみません、道^{みち}が混^こんでいて遅^{おく}れました」 A 「そうでしたか。来^こられないのかと思^{おも}っていました」

A: You were late. B: I'm sorry, the road was crowded, so I was delayed. A: I see. I thought you might not be able to come.

Example

A 「遅^{おそ}いね」 B 「ごめん、道^{みち}が混^こんでたから、遅^{おく}れちゃった」 A 「ああ、来^こないのかと思^{おも}った」

A: You're late. B: Sorry, the road was crowded, so I was delayed. A: Oh, I thought you weren't coming.

Notes

"Konai no ka to omotta" is a phrase used to express that the speaker thought someone might not come. The word "konai" is the negative form of the verb "kuru" (to come). In this expression, "no ka" forms an embedded question, "to" marks the content of thought, and "omotta" is the past tense of the verb "omou" (to think).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expressing that one thought the other person might not come

reacting to someone arriving late

sharing worry or anxiety

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

response expression

worry

lateness

thought expression

By the way

ちなみに

Chinamini

By the way

Variants

- ちなみに
by the way
- ちなみに言うと
incidentally
- そうそう、ちなみに
on a related note

Adjusted Expression

かれ わかて にんき が か ぼそく かれ ちちおや が か
彼は若手で人気のある画家です。なお、補足しますと、彼の父親も画家です。

He is a popular young painter. As supplementary information, his father is also a painter.

Example

かれ わかて いちばんにんき が か かれ ちちおや が か
彼は、若手で一番人気のある画家です。そうそう、ちなみに、彼の父親も画家です。

He is one of the most popular young painters. By the way, his father is also a painter.

Notes

"Chinamini" is a phrase used to provide additional information or related facts. It introduces a related topic or adds supplementary information that is not central to the main point but is still connected to it. The word "chinamini" can be translated as "by the way," "incidentally," or "on a related note."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

adding related information

presenting supplementary information

slightly expanding the topic

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

discourse marker

supplement

related information

topic development

Listen carefully

みみ す
耳を澄ませて

Mimi o sumasete

Listen carefully

Variants

- 耳を澄ませて
listen carefully
- 耳を澄まして
listen closely
- よく聞いて
listen for it

Adjusted Expression

すこ しず とり こえ き
少し静かにして、鳥の声が聞こえるかどうか、よく聞いてみてください。

Please be quiet for a moment and listen carefully to see whether you can hear the birds.

Example

みみ す とり き
耳を澄ませて、鳥の声、聞こえる？

Listen carefully. Can you hear the birds singing?

Notes

"Mimi o sumasete" is a phrase used to ask someone to listen carefully or to pay attention to a sound or voice. The word "mimi" means "ear," "o" is

a particle that marks the object of the verb, and "sumasete" is the te-form of the verb "sumasu" (to clear). Literally, it means "clear your ears," but as an expression it means to listen closely.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- encouraging someone to listen carefully
- calling attention to a faint sound
- sharing awareness of a sound

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- request expression
- hearing expression
- calling attention
- natural sound

Let me think about it for a moment

かんが
ちょっと考えさせてください

Chotto kangaesasete kudasai

Let me think about it for a moment

Variants

- ちょっと考えさせてください
let me think about it for a moment
- 少し考えさせてください
please give me a moment to think
- 少し時間をください
please give me some time to think

Adjusted Expression

A 「今、決めるのは早いですか」 B 「すみません。すぐには判断できませんので、少し考える時間をいただけますか」

A: Is it too early to decide now? B: I'm sorry. I cannot decide immediately, so could I have a little time to think?

Example

A 「今、決めるのは早いですか？」 B 「ちょっと考えさせてください」

A: Is it too early to decide now? B: Let me think about it for a moment.

Notes

"Chotto kangaesasete kudasai" is a phrase used to ask someone to give you a moment to think about something. The word "chotto" means "a little" or "a bit," "kangaesasete" is the causative te-form of the verb "kangaeru" (to think), and "kudasai" is a polite request form. When asking someone to allow you to do something, Japanese often uses the causative te-form plus "kudasai."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

avoiding an immediate answer

asking for time to think

putting a decision on hold

Tags EN

immediate grammar

polite expression

request expression

deferring judgment

securing time

causative expression

This time, it's an exception

こんかい とくべつ
今回、特別ね。

Konkai, tokubetsu ne.

This time, it's an exception

Variants

- 今回、特別ね。
this time, it's an exception
- 今回は特別ね。
just this once
- 今回だけ特別ね。
this time only

Adjusted Expression

A 「もう一つ^{ひと た}食べてもいいですか」 B 「今回は例外^{こんかい れいがい}として、もう一つ^{ひと たべ}食べてもいいですよ」

A: May I have one more? B: As an exception this time, you may have one more.

Example

A 「ママ、もう一つ^{ひと た}、食べてもいい？」 B 「今回^{こんかい}、特別^{とくべつ}ね」

A: Mom, can I have one more? B: Just this once.

Notes

"Konkai, tokubetsu ne" is a phrase used to indicate that something is being allowed as a special exception this time. The word "konkai" means "this time," "tokubetsu" means "special" or "exceptional," and "ne" is a sentence-ending particle that lightly seeks shared understanding. This expression acknowledges that the current permission is an exceptional measure and should not be taken as the usual rule.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

allowing something just this once

giving exceptional permission

accepting someone's request

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

response expression

permission

exception

parent-child conversation

I finally got used to it

ようやく^な慣れました。

Youyaku nare mashita.

I finally got used to it

Variants

- ようやく慣れました。
I finally got used to it.
- やっと慣れました。
I have finally gotten used to it.
- 日本の生活にようやく慣れました。
I finally got used to life in Japan.

Adjusted Expression

A 「日本^{にほん}での生活^{せいかつ}には、もう慣^なれましたか」 B 「はい、時間^{じかん}はかかりましたが、ようやく慣^なれてきました」

A: Have you gotten used to life in Japan? B: Yes, it took some time, but I have finally started to get used to it.

Example

A 「日本^{にほん}の生活^{せいかつ}、慣^なれた？」 B 「うん、ようやく慣^なれました」

A: Have you gotten used to life in Japan? B: Yes, I finally got used to it.

Notes

"Youyaku naremashita" is a phrase used to express that someone has finally gotten used to something. The word "youyaku" is an adverb that means "it took a long time, but finally," and "naremashita" is the past polite form of the verb "nareru" (to be accustomed to).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expressing that one has gotten used to something after some time

reporting adaptation to life

sharing relief or a sense of achievement

Tags EN

immediate grammar

polite expression

response expression

adaptation

daily life

sense of achievement

Even if you do it

したとしても

Shita to shite mo

Even if you do it

Variants

- したとしても
even if you do it
- 勉強したとしても
even if you study
- 仮にそうしたとしても
even supposing that you did so

Adjusted Expression

A 「たとえ一生懸命勉強したとしても、合格できなければ意味がないと思います」 B 「まだ試していないのですから、そう決めつけることはできません」

A: Even if you study hard, I think it is meaningless if you cannot pass. B: Since you have not tried yet, you cannot decide that in advance.

Example

A 「一生懸命、勉強したとしても、合格できないじゃ意味がないよ」 B 「やってもみないのにそんなことわからないよ」

A: Even if you study hard, it's meaningless if you can't pass. B: You don't know that if you don't even try.

Notes

"Shita to shite mo" is a phrase used to express a hypothetical situation or condition. The word "shita" is the past tense of the verb "suru" (to do), and "to shite mo" means "even if we suppose that." This phrase is often used to introduce a hypothetical case and then state that the result or judgment would still not change.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expressing a hypothetical condition

presenting the possibility that effort may not lead to results

expressing a negative outlook

Tags EN

immediate grammar

conditional expression

hypothesis

concession

outlook

effort

That's really good

いいですね、すごく。

Ii desu ne, sugoku.

That's really good

Variants

- いいですね、すごく。
that's really good
- いいね、すごく。
that's very nice
- すごくいいですね。
it's really impressive

Adjusted Expression

A 「この^え絵はどうですか」 B 「すごくいいですね」

A: What do you think of this painting? B: It is really good.

Example

A 「この^え絵、どう」 B 「いいですね、すごく」

A: What do you think of this painting? B: That's really good.

Notes

"Ii desu ne, sugoku" is a spoken phrase used to express that something is good or impressive. The word "ii" means "good" or "nice," "desu" is the polite form of the copula "da" (to be), "ne" is a sentence-ending particle that lightly seeks shared feeling or confirmation, and "sugoku" is an

adverb that means "very" or "really." In speech, the speaker first says "ii desu ne" and then adds "sugoku" afterward to strengthen the evaluation. This word order sounds natural in conversation, but in writing or in a more adjusted expression, "sugoku ii desu ne" is usually more appropriate.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- strengthening an evaluation after saying it
- expressing a strong impression
- adding to an evaluation while speaking

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- evaluative expression
- inversion
- emphasis
- impression

Details after this song

くわ 詳しくは、この^{きょく}曲のあとで。

Kuwashiku wa, kono kyoku no atode.

Details after this song.

Variants

- 詳しくは、この曲のあとで。
details after this song
- 詳しくは、後ほど。
more details later
- 詳しくは、このあとすぐ。
more after this

Adjusted Expression

くわ 詳しくは、この^{きょく}曲が^お終わった^{あと}後にご^{せつめい}説明いたします。

I will explain this in detail after this song is over.

Example

A 「これ、^{ぶ れ ぜ ん と}プレゼント？」 B 「ええ、^{くわ}詳しくは、この^{きょく}曲のあとで」

A: Is this a present? B: Yes. Details after this song.

Notes

"Kuwashiku wa, kono kyoku no ato" is used to indicate that more detailed explanation will come after the current song. The word "kuwashiku" means "in detail," "wa" marks the topic, "kono" means

"this," "kyoku" means "song," and "ato" means "after." The final predicate is omitted, but the meaning is clear from the situation. This kind of expression is strongly context-dependent and works well in real-time speech because the listener can infer the missing part from what is happening at that moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- postponing an explanation
- announcing information to come shortly after
- context-dependent elliptical expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- elliptical expression
- context-dependent expression
- real-time expression
- preview

From now on

これから

Kore kara

From now on

Variants

- これから
from now on
- これから食事
after this
- これからどうする？
what are you going to do now?

Adjusted Expression

A 「お^{しごと}仕事は^お終わりましたか」 B 「はい。この^{あと}後、^{ゆうじん}友人と^{しょくじ}食事^いに行く^{よてい}予定です」

A: Have you finished work? B: Yes. After this, I am planning to go out for dinner with a friend.

Example

A 「仕^{しごと}仕事、^お終わった？」 B 「うん、これから、^{ともだち}友達と^{しょくじ}食事」

A: Are you done with work? B: Yeah, after this, I'm having dinner with a friend.

Notes

"Kore kara" means "from now on" and is used to indicate that something will happen after the present moment. The word "kore" means "this,"

and "kara" is a particle that indicates the starting point of an action, event, or period. In conversation, "kore kara" often means "after this" or "from now," referring to the speaker's next action. In writing, it can also be used more broadly to mean "in the future."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- indicating an action from now on
- presenting the next plan
- moving from the present into the future

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- time expression
- schedule expression
- future
- elliptical expression

It just finished

ちょうど^{いま}今、^{でき}出来たところ。

Choudo ima, dekita tokoro.

It just finished.

Variants

- ちょうど今、出来たところ。

it just finished

- 今できたところ。

it just got done

- ちょうど今できました。

it is ready right now

Adjusted Expression

A 「何^{なに}を^{つく}っているのですか」 B 「ちょうど^{いま}今、^{か れ ー}カレーうどんが^{でき あ}出来上がりました」

A: What are you making? B: The curry udon has just finished cooking.

Example

A 「何^{なに}、^{つく}ってるの？」 B 「ちょうど^{いま}今、^{か れ ー}カレーうどん、^{でき}できたところ」

A: What are you making? B: The curry udon just got done.

Notes

"Choudo ima, dekita tokoro" is a phrase used to indicate that something has just been completed. The word "choudo" means "just" or "exactly,"

"ima" means "now," "dekita" is the past tense of the verb "dekiru" (to be completed or to be ready), and "tokoro" means "point" or "moment" in this expression. This phrase often suggests good timing, as the thing in question has become ready right at the moment it is needed or asked about.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expressing that something has just been completed
- sharing good timing
- reporting something immediately to the other person

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- time expression
- just completed
- cooking situation
- timing

I have allergies

あ れ る ぎ ー
アレルギーがあります

Arerugii ga arimasu

I have allergies

Variants

- アレルギーがあります

I have allergies

- アレルギーがあって

I have an allergy

- 花粉症です

I have hay fever

Adjusted Expression

A 「花粉^{かふん}は大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}ですか」 B 「少しアレルギー^{あ れ る ぎ ー}がありますので、目が痒^{め かゆ}くなっています」

A: Are you all right with pollen? B: I have a slight allergy, so my eyes are itchy.

Example

A 「花粉^{かふん}、大丈夫^{だいじょうぶ}？」 B 「ちょっと、アレルギー^{あ れ る ぎ ー}があって、目が痒^{め かゆ}くて」

A: Are you okay with pollen? B: I have allergies, so my eyes are itchy.

Notes

"Kafun" means "pollen" and "arerugii" means "allergy." The word "daijoubu" means "okay" or "fine." The word "me" means "eye," and "kayui" means "itchy." The phrase "arerugii ga arimasu" is used to indicate that someone has allergies. The particle "ga" marks what exists or what one has, and "arimasu" is the polite form of the verb "aru" (to exist or to have in this context). In Japan, when spring comes, cedar pollen spreads through the air, and many people have allergy symptoms. This condition is called "kafunshou."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expressing a physical condition or symptom

explaining the reason for discomfort

sharing a reaction to pollen

Tags EN

immediate grammar

polite expression

state expression

physical condition

allergy

hay fever

I can't get through

つな
繋がらない

Tsunagaranai

I can't get through

Variants

- 繋がらない
I can't get through
- 電話が繋がらない
the phone won't connect
- ネットが繋がらない
the internet won't connect

Adjusted Expression

A 「電話^{でんわ}が繋^{つな}がりません」 B 「携^け帯^{いた}電話^{でんわ}の電^{でん}池^ちが切^きれているのかもしれませんが」

A: The phone will not connect. B: The cell phone battery may have run out.

Example

A 「電話^{でんわ}、繋^{つな}がらない」 B 「携^け帯^{いた}、電^{でん}池^ち、切^きれてるかも」

A: I can't get through on the phone. B: Your cell phone battery may be dead.

Notes

"Tsunagaranai" is a phrase used to indicate that you cannot connect by phone, internet, or another communication channel. The word "denwa" means "phone," and "tsunagaranai" is the negative form of the intransitive verb "tsunagaru" (to connect). "Keitai" means "cell phone" or "mobile phone," "denchi" means "battery," and "kireteru" is a contracted form of "kirete iru," which expresses the current state resulting from the verb "kireru" (to run out, to be cut off).

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expressing inability to contact someone

expressing a connection problem

talking about a possible cause

Tags EN

immediate grammar

colloquial

state expression

communication

phone

connection problem

What happened?

どうかしたの？

Douka shita no?

What happened?

Variants

- どうかしたの？
what happened?
- どうかしましたか？
is something wrong?
- 何かあったの？
did something happen?

Adjusted Expression

A 「急に^{きゅう}顔色^{かおいろ}が悪^{わる}くなりましたね。何^{なに}かありましたか」 B 「はい、少し^{すこ}頭^{あたま}が痛^{いた}いです」

A: Your face suddenly looks pale. Did something happen? B: Yes, I have a slight headache.

Example

A 「急に^{きゅう}顔色^{かおいろ}が悪^{わる}くなったね。どうかしたの？」 B 「うん、頭^{あたま}が痛^{いた}いの」

A: You suddenly look pale. What happened? B: Yeah, I have a headache.

Notes

"Douka shita no?" is a phrase used to ask someone what happened when you notice a change in their appearance, behavior, or condition. The

phrase "douka shita" means "something is wrong" or "something happened," and "shita" is the past tense of the verb "suru" (to do). The sentence-final particle "no" makes the question sound softer and asks for an explanation of the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- asking after noticing a change in someone
- checking someone's condition or state
- expressing concern

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- question expression
- concern
- checking condition
- reaction to change

Why not?

どうしてだめなの

Doushite dame na no?

Why not?

Variants

- どうしてだめなの？
why not?
- どうしてだめ？
why is it not allowed?
- なんでだめなの？
how come I can't do that?

Adjusted Expression

A 「これはしてはいけません」 B 「なぜ、それをしてはいけないのでしょうか」

A: You must not do this. B: Why is it not allowed?

Example

A 「これしちゃだめ」 B 「どうしてだめなの？」

A: Don't do this. B: Why not?

Notes

"Doushite dame na no?" is a phrase used to ask why something is not good or why something is not allowed. The word "doushite" means "why," and "dame" means "no good" or "not allowed." In "dame na no," "na" connects the na-adjective "dame" to "no," and the sentence-final "no"

asks for an explanation. This phrase is used when the speaker has been told not to do something and wants to know the reason. Of course, you can also use just "doushite?"

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- asking why something is forbidden
- expressing that one is not convinced
- asking for the reason behind someone's judgment

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- colloquial
- question expression
- asking for a reason
- prohibition
- dissatisfaction

Sir

おとうさん

Otousan

Sir

Variants

- お父さん
sir
- おとうさん
excuse me, sir
- そこのお父さん
the gentleman there

Adjusted Expression

A 「すみません、そちらの男性の方、節税についてご関心はありますか？」 B
「ええ、あります」

A: Excuse me, sir, would you be interested in tax planning? B: Yes, I would.

Example

A 「ちょっと、そこの^{と う}お父さん、^{せつぜい}節税してますか？」 B 「ええ、してますよ」

A: Excuse me, sir, are you doing tax planning? B: Yes, I am.

Notes

"Otousan" usually refers politely to someone else's father, and it can also be used when addressing one's own father. In this example, however, it is

used to call out to a middle-aged man passing by. The speaker does not know whether he is actually someone's father. The expression works because the speaker immediately selects a socially recognizable role, rather than identifying the person precisely. In English, this use is usually rendered as "sir," not as "father" or "dad."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To address a middle-aged man in passing, not as one's actual father, but by using a socially recognizable role-based form of address.

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- address term
- calling out
- context-dependent expression
- social role
- spoken language

Miss

おねえさん

Oneesan

Miss

Variants

- お姉さん
miss
- おねえさん
young lady
- そこのお姉さん
the lady there

Adjusted Expression

A 「すみません、そちらの方、何を飲んでいらっしゃるんですか？」 B 「コーヒーです」

A: Excuse me, may I ask what you are drinking? B: Coffee.

Example

A 「お^{ねえ}姉さん、何^{なに}、飲^のんでるの？」 B 「コ^こー^ーヒ^ひー」

A: Miss, what are you drinking? B: Coffee.

Notes

"Oneesan" usually refers politely to someone else's older sister, and it can also be used when addressing one's own older sister. In this example, however, it is used to call out to a woman who is not the speaker's older

sister. This use depends strongly on the situation. It can sound familiar, casual, or even rude, especially when used toward a woman the speaker does not know. In English, it should not be translated literally as "older sister" in this context. A closer rendering is "miss," though even that does not fully capture the social awkwardness of the Japanese expression.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To address a woman who is not one's older sister by using an age- or appearance-based form of address, though it can sound overly familiar or rude depending on the situation.

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- address term
- calling out
- context-dependent expression
- kinship term
- spoken language
- rude expression

Your younger brother

おとうとさん

Otouto-san

your younger brother

Variants

- 弟さん
your younger brother
- おとうとさん
your younger brother, wasn't he
- 弟さんでしたよね
your younger brother, if I remember correctly

Adjusted Expression

A 「たしか、弟さんはお医者さまでいらっしゃいましたよね？」 B 「ええ、弟は今、NPO 法人で働いています」

A: If I remember correctly, your younger brother was a doctor, wasn't he?

B: Yes, my younger brother now works for an NPO.

Example

A ^{おとうと}「弟さん、^{たし}確か^{いしや}お医者さんでしたよね？」 B ^{おとうと}「ええ、^{いま}弟は^{ほうじん}今、NPO 法人で^{はたら}働いていますよ」

A: Your younger brother was a doctor, wasn't he? B: Yes, my younger brother is working for an NPO now.

Notes

"Otouto-san" is a polite way to refer to someone else's younger brother. When referring to one's own younger brother in conversation, the usual form is "otouto," without "san." When addressing one's own younger brother directly, neither "otouto-san" nor "otouto" is normally used; the person is usually called by name. In this example, the speaker recalls and confirms something previously heard about the other person's younger brother. The "deshita" in "oishasan deshita yo ne" is the past tense of "desu," but here it marks recalled knowledge and confirmation. It does not necessarily mean that the younger brother is no longer a doctor.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To politely confirm something about the other person's younger brother while recalling information heard earlier.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

kinship term

polite expression

confirmation

recall

past tense

spoken language

Kind of like...

みたいな

Mitai na

Kind of like...

Variants

- みたいな
kind of like...
- みたいな感じ
something like that
- そんな感じ
that kind of feeling
- みたいなもの
or something

Adjusted Expression

A 「(:)懐かしい(:)気持ちになりますね」 B 「ええ、懐^{なつ}かしさもありますが、
どう^{どう}じ^じすこ^{すこ}同時に少しわくわくする感^{かん}じもあります」

A: It makes me feel nostalgic. B: Yes, it feels nostalgic, but at the same time, it also feels a little exciting.

Example

A 「懐^{なつ}かしい気^き持^もちになるよね」 B 「うん、懐^{なつ}かしいけど、ワクワクする、み
たいな」

A: It makes me feel nostalgic. B: Yeah, it's nostalgic, but also exciting, or something like that.

Notes

"Mitai na" can mean "like" or "something like," but in this example it is not simply expressing similarity. The speaker first says "natsukashii kedo, wakuwaku suru" and then adds "mitai na" at the end. This makes the utterance sound approximate, as if the speaker is still searching for the right words. Rather than giving a fixed explanation, the speaker leaves the feeling slightly open. Expressions such as "mitai na kanji" and "sonna kanji" work in a similar way in casual speech. In English, this use is closer to "or something like that" or "that kind of feeling" than to a literal "like."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To soften an utterance by leaving the description approximate, as if the speaker is searching for a close way to express a feeling or impression.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

softening expression

approximation

unfinished utterance

expression of feeling

spoken language

I'm sorry to hear that

お^き気^{どく}の毒さま

O-ki no doku sama

I'm sorry to hear that

Variants

- お気の毒さま
I'm sorry to hear that
- それはお気の毒さま
That's too bad
- お気の毒に
That's unfortunate
- それは大変でしたね
That must have been rough

Adjusted Expression

A 「昨日、メガネ^{きのう めがね}をなくしました」 B 「それは大変^{たいへん}でしたね。その後^ご、見つ^みかりましたか？」

A: I lost my glasses yesterday. B: I'm sorry to hear that. Were you able to find them afterward?

Example

A 「昨日、メガネ^{きのう めがね}、なくした」 B 「それは、お気^きの毒^{どく}さま。で、見つ^みかった？」

A: I lost my glasses yesterday. B: That's too bad. So, did you find them?

Notes

"O-ki no doku sama" is an expression used to show sympathy when someone has experienced something unfortunate. In this example, the situation is not extremely serious, so the expression works as a light reaction, close to "That's too bad" or "I'm sorry to hear that." The following "de, mitsukatta?" quickly moves the conversation forward, so the sympathy is brief and immediate rather than deeply formal. The form contains "o," a polite prefix, "ki," meaning "mind" or "feeling," "no," a linking particle, "doku," literally "poison," and "sama," an honorific-like suffix. However, the expression should be understood as a fixed phrase, not by mechanically combining the literal meanings of each part.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To show sympathy or concern in response to something unfortunate or troublesome that happened to the other person.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

sympathy expression

reaction expression

concern

spoken language

formulaic expression

I'm into it

...に^{むちゅう}夢中です

...ni muchuu desu

I'm into it

Variants

- ...に夢中です
I'm into ...
- ...に夢中になっています
I'm really into ...
- 最近、...にはまっています
I'm absorbed in ...
- ...が好きでたまりません
I'm hooked on ...

Adjusted Expression

A 「最近^{さいきん}、特^{とく}に関心^{かんしん}を持^もっていることはありますか？」 B 「最近^{さいきん}は、読書^{どくしょ}にか
なり熱中^{ねっちゅう}しています」

A: Is there anything you are especially interested in these days? B:
Recently, I have been very absorbed in reading.

Example

A 「最近^{さいきん}、何^{なに}に夢中^{むちゅう}？」 B 「読書^{どくしょ}に夢中^{むちゅう}です」

A: What are you into lately? B: I'm into reading.

Notes

"Muchuu" means being absorbed in something or deeply caught up in it. In the pattern "...ni muchuu desu," the particle "ni" marks the thing toward which the speaker's interest or absorption is directed. This is not an action in the narrow sense, but a state of being absorbed. In casual English, "I'm into reading" is a natural translation. Depending on the context, "I'm absorbed in reading" or "I'm really into reading" may also work. Saying "dokusho ni muchuu desu" can give a studious impression, although "reading" may of course include many kinds of reading, including manga.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To say that one is strongly interested in something or absorbed in it these days.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

interest expression

state expression

self-description

spoken language

formulaic expression

I can't believe it

しん
信じられない

Shinjirarenai

I can't believe it

Variants

- 信じられない
I can't believe it
- 信じられないよ
I can't believe this
- ほんと信じられない
Unbelievable
- ありえない
That's unbelievable

Adjusted Expression

A 「お待たせしました」 B 「1時間も遅れるとは思いませんでした。かなり困りました」

A: Sorry to keep you waiting. B: I did not expect you to be an hour late. It was quite inconvenient.

Example

A 「お待たせ」 B 「信じられない。1時間も遅れて」

A: Sorry to keep you waiting. B: I can't believe it. You're an hour late.

Notes

"Shinjirarenai" is the negative potential form of "shinjiru," meaning "to believe." Literally, it means "cannot believe." In actual conversation, however, it often works as an immediate reaction to something surprising, unacceptable, or upsetting. In this example, the speaker is not simply saying that the fact is difficult to believe. The expression also carries blame and frustration toward the person who arrived an hour late. The following phrase, "ichijikan mo okurete," gives the reason for the reaction after the emotional response has already been expressed.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To immediately express disbelief, shock, exasperation, or complaint toward something hard to accept.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

surprise

blame

complaint

reaction expression

negative potential

spoken language

It looks interesting

おもしろそう

Omoshirosou

It looks interesting

Variants

- おもしろそう
It looks interesting
- これ、おもしろそう
This looks interesting
- なんかおもしろそう
That looks fun
- 楽しそう
That sounds interesting

Adjusted Expression

この映画は、^{えいが}内容^{ないよう}を見る^みかぎり、おもしろそうですね。

Judging from what I can see, this movie looks interesting.

Example

この映画、^{えいが}おもしろそう。

This movie looks interesting.

Notes

"Omoshirosou" is used when something gives the speaker the impression that it may be interesting or fun. It is formed from "omoshiroi," meaning "interesting" or "fun," and "sou," which indicates an impression based on what the speaker can see, hear, or otherwise perceive. In this example, the speaker is not saying that the movie is already known to be interesting. The speaker is reacting to a first impression, such as a trailer, poster, title, or recommendation. The expression is immediate because the evaluation is made before full confirmation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To immediately express interest based on a first impression from seeing or hearing about something.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

impression expression

inference expression

evaluation

reaction expression

spoken language

I'll leave it to you

まか
お任せします

Omakase shimasu

I'll leave it to you

Variants

- お任せします
I'll leave it to you
- お任せしますよ
I'll leave that up to you
- 任せます
It's up to you
- あなたに任せます
I'll trust your choice
- お任せでお願いします
Chef's choice, please

Adjusted Expression

A 「どこで晩ごはんを食べましょうか？」 B 「私は特に希望がありませんので、
場所はそちらで決めていただいてもかまいません」

A: Where shall we have dinner? B: I do not have any particular preference, so please feel free to choose the place.

Example

A 「どこで晩ごはん、食べる？」 B 「お任せします」

A: Where do you want to eat dinner? B: I'll leave it to you.

Notes

"Omakase shimasu" is a set expression used when leaving a decision or task to someone else. It is formed from "omakase," meaning entrusting or leaving something to another person, and "shimasu," the polite form of "suru." In this example, the speaker does not choose the place for dinner and instead lets the other person decide. The expression is polite, but it is also common in casual relationships because it has become fixed as a formulaic phrase. Saying only "makaseru" can sound rough or, depending on the context, as if the speaker is placing responsibility on the other person from above. "Omakase" is also used in restaurants, especially sushi restaurants, when the customer leaves the menu selection to the chef.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To leave a decision or choice to the other person, trusting their judgment.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

entrusting expression

delegating judgment

polite expression

formulaic expression

spoken language

You know what?

あのね

Ano ne

You know what?

Variants

- あのね

You know what?

- あのさ

Listen

- ねえ、あのね

Hey, listen

- あのね、聞いて

Can I tell you something?

Adjusted Expression

A 「ねえ、^まママ、^{つた}伝えたいことがあるんだけど、^まママのことが^{だいす}大好きだよ」 B
「ありがとう」

A: Mom, there is something I want to tell you. I love you very much. B:
Thank you.

Example

A 「あのね、^まママ、^{だいす}大好きだよ」 B 「ありがとう」

A: You know what, Mom? I love you so much. B: Thank you.

Notes

"Ano ne" is used when the speaker is about to begin saying something and wants to draw the listener's attention gently. "Ano" can work like a hesitation marker or a soft opening, and "ne" invites the listener into the speaker's space of attention. In this example, the child does not simply say "I love you." The child first says "ano ne," creating a small opening before expressing an important feeling. The expression often appears before something personal, affectionate, difficult to say, or emotionally important. In English, it may be rendered as "You know what?" or "Can I tell you something?" depending on the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To gently draw the listener's attention before saying something personal, important, or emotionally meaningful.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

opening expression

attention-getting

emotional expression

intimate expression

spoken language

I thought you weren't coming

こ おも
来ないのかと思っただよ

Konai no ka to omotta yo

I thought you weren't coming

Variants

- 来ないのかと思っただよ

I thought you weren't coming

- もう来ないのかと思っただ

I thought you might not come

- 来ないかと思っただよ

I was starting to think you weren't coming

- 来ないんじゃないかと思っただ

I was worried you wouldn't show up

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{おそ}遅くなって、ごめんなさい」 B 「なかなか^こ来なかったの、もう^こ来ないの
ではないかと^{しんぱい}心配していました」

A: I'm sorry I'm late. B: Since you did not arrive for quite a while, I was worried that you might not come.

Example

A 「^{おそ}遅くなって、ごめん」 B 「^こ来ないのかと^{おも}思っただよ」

A: Sorry I'm late. B: I thought you weren't coming.

Notes

"Konai no ka to omotta yo" is used after the person has arrived, to express what the speaker had been thinking while waiting. The speaker is not saying that the person did not come. Rather, the speaker is saying that, before the arrival, they were beginning to think, "Are they not coming?" In "konai no ka," "no ka" forms an embedded question, and "to" marks the content of thought. The final "omotta yo" makes the utterance a reaction after the situation has changed. In English, "I thought you weren't coming" is more natural here than "I thought that you wouldn't come," because it sounds like a reaction to someone who has just arrived.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To tell someone after they arrive that the speaker had been worried they might not come.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

worry expression

confirmation

reaction expression

quotation

past tense

spoken language

It can't be helped

しかた
仕方がない

Shikata ga nai

It can't be helped

Variants

- 仕方がない
It can't be helped
- 仕方ない
There's nothing we can do
- 仕方がないね
That's just how it is
- しょうがない
Oh well
- しょうがないね

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{あめ}雨が^ふ降ってきましたね」 B 「そうですね。^{てんき}天気は^か変えられませんから、このま^いま行くしかありませんね」

A: It has started raining. B: Yes. Since we cannot change the weather, we will just have to go on as we are.

Example

A 「^{あめ}雨、^ふ降ってきた」 B 「^{しかた}仕方がないね」

A: It's started raining. B: It can't be helped.

Notes

"Shikata ga nai" means that there is no effective way to change the situation. "Shikata" means a way or method, "ga" marks what is absent, and "nai" means that it does not exist. In actual conversation, however, the phrase is usually understood as a fixed expression meaning "It can't be helped" or "There's nothing we can do." In this example, the speaker reacts to the rain by accepting the situation rather than trying to explain it. The final "ne" softens the expression and shares the acceptance with the listener. The more casual form "shouganai" is also very common in speech.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To express that an unwanted situation cannot be changed and has to be accepted.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

acceptance expression

resignation

reaction expression

situational judgment

spoken language

formulaic expression

I would have done it

...V-ta のに

...V-ta noni

I would have done it

Variants

- 行ったのに
I would have gone
- 迎えに行ったのに
I would have picked you up
- 言ってくれればよかったのに
You should have told me
- 早く言ってくれればよかったのに
If only you had told me earlier

Adjusted Expression

A 「え、^{ある}歩いて^き来たんですか？」 B 「はい」 A 「^{でんわ}電話してくだされば、^{わたし}私が^{むか}迎え^いに行くこともできました」

A: What? You walked here? B: Yes. A: If you had called me, I could have come to pick you up.

Example

A 「え、^{ある}歩いて来たの？」 B 「うん」 A 「^{でんわ}電話してくれれば、^{むか}迎え^いに行ったのに」

A: Huh? You walked here? B: Yeah. A: If you had called me, I would've picked you up.

Notes

"Noni" can mean "although" or "even though," but in this example it works at the end of a counterfactual expression. The condition is given by "denwa shite kurereba," meaning "if you had called me." The following "mukae ni itta noni" means that the speaker would have gone to pick the person up, but that this did not happen. The final "noni" adds a feeling of regret, disappointment, or missed possibility. It is therefore not simply a conjunction connecting two clauses. In conversation, it can close the utterance while leaving the unrealized action and the speaker's feeling strongly present.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To express regret or disappointment about something that did not happen, often implying what the speaker would have done under different circumstances.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

hypothetical expression

regret expression

disappointment

counterfactual

reaction expression

spoken language

Where are you?

どこにいるの

Doko ni iru no

Where are you?

Variants

- どこにいるの

Where are you?

- 今、どこにいるの

Where are you now?

- どこにいる？

Where are you at?

- 今どこ？

Where are you located?

- どこにいますか

Where are you right now?

Adjusted Expression

A 「今^{いま}、どちらにいらっしゃいますか？」 B 「図書館^{としょかん}にいます」

A: Where are you now? B: I am at the library.

Example

A 「今^{いま}、どこにいるの？」 B 「図書館^{としょかん}にいるよ」

A: Where are you now? B: I'm at the library.

Notes

"Doko ni iru no" is used to ask where someone is. "Doko" means "where," "ni" marks the location where someone exists or stays, and "iru" means "to be" or "to be there" for a person or other animate being. The final "no" does not simply mark confirmation. In casual conversation, it softens the question and makes it sound as if the speaker is asking for the situation behind the answer. This expression is often used on the phone, in messaging, or when trying to find someone. A shorter form such as "ima doko?" is more casual, while "doko ni imasu ka" is more formal.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To ask where the other person is at the present moment.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

question expression

location check

situation check

sentence-final particle

spoken language

Look at this

み み
見て見て、これ

Mite mite, kore

Look at this

Variants

- 見て見て、これ

Look at this

- 見て、これ

Look, this

- これ見て

Take a look at this

- ちょっと見て

Hey, look at this

- ねえ、見て見て

Check this out

Adjusted Expression

A 「これを^み見てもらえますか？」 B 「何^{なん}ですか？」

A: Could you take a look at this? B: What is it?

Example

A 「^み見て^み見て、これ」 B 「何^{なに}？」

A: Look at this. B: What?

Notes

"Mite mite, kore" is used when the speaker wants to draw someone's attention to something immediately. "Mite" is the te-form of "miru," meaning "to see" or "to look," and the repetition "mite mite" makes the call more urgent, lively, or childlike. The object "kore" comes after the attention-getting expression. In a more adjusted sentence, the order would be "kore o mite," meaning "look at this." In actual conversation, however, the speaker first activates the listener's action, "Look, look," and then presents the object, "this." This order gives the expression its immediacy.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To quickly draw the listener's attention or gaze toward something the speaker wants to show.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

attention-getting

gaze direction

deictic expression

request for reaction

word order

spoken language

Let me see

どれどれ

Dore dore

Let me see

Variants

- どれどれ

Let me see

- どれ

Let's see

- どれ、見せて

Let me take a look

- ちょっと見せて

Show me

Adjusted Expression

A 「これ、^み見てください」 B 「はい、^み見せてください。^{かくにん}確認しますね」

A: Please look at this. B: Sure, please show it to me. I'll take a look.

Example

A 「これ、^み見て」 B 「どれどれ」

A: Look at this. B: Let me see.

Notes

"Dore dore" is an immediate reaction used when someone shows something or calls attention to something and the speaker moves to check it. Literally, "dore" means "which one," but in this repeated form it does not simply ask for a choice. It works more like "Let me see" or "Let's take a look." The verb is not stated, but the situation supplies the missing action: looking, checking, or inspecting. The repetition gives the expression a soft, responsive, and sometimes slightly playful tone. It is often heard when an adult responds to a child who is showing something, but it can also be used casually among adults.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To respond by moving toward seeing or checking something that the other person is showing or referring to.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

reaction expression

checking expression

context-dependent expression

repetition

ellipsis

spoken language

I told you so

だから言^いったじゃん

Dakara itta jan

I told you so

Variants

- だから言^いったじゃん
I told you so
- だから言^いったでしょ
See? I told you
- ほら、言^いったじゃん
That's what I said
- 言^いったじゃん、行き止まりだって
I told you it was a dead end

Adjusted Expression

A 「この道^{みち}は通^{とお}れませんね」 B 「ですから、先^{さき}ほど、この道^{みち}は行^いき止^どまりだと
申^{もう}上げました」 A 「すみません」

A: We cannot go through this road. B: That is why I said earlier that this road was a dead end. A: Sorry.

Example

A 「この道^{みち}は通^{とお}れないね」 B 「だから、言^いったじゃん、行^いき止^どまりだって」 A
「ごめんごめん」

A: We can't go through this road. B: See? I told you it was a dead end. A: Sorry, sorry.

Notes

"Dakara itta jan" is used when something the speaker said earlier has turned out to be correct. "Dakara" links the present situation to the earlier warning or comment. "Itta" is the past form of "iu," meaning "to say." The final "jan" is a casual sentence ending related to "ja nai," and it suggests that the other person should recognize or admit what the speaker is saying. In this example, the speaker first reacts with "dakara, itta jan" and then adds the content afterward, "ikidomari datte," meaning "that it was a dead end." The important point comes first as a reaction, and the explanation follows. This gives the expression its immediate conversational force.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To point out that what the speaker said earlier has turned out to be correct, often with a light tone of blame or confirmation.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

reaction expression

confirmation

blame

context-dependent expression

contracted expression

spoken language

When are you coming back?

いつ、^{もど}戻ってくるの

Itsu, modotte kuru no

When are you coming back?

Variants

- いつ、戻ってくるの
When are you coming back?
- いつ戻るの
When will you be back?
- 何時ごろ戻ってくるの
What time will you be back?
- いつ帰ってくるの
When are you returning?
- いつ戻ってきますか

Adjusted Expression

A 「いつごろ^{もど}戻ってくる^{よてい}予定ですか？」 B 「夕方^{ゆうがた}には^{もど}戻る^{よてい}予定です」

A: Around when do you expect to be back? B: I expect to be back by the evening.

Example

A 「いつ、^{もど}戻ってくるの？」 B 「夕方^{ゆうがた}には^{もど}戻るよ」

A: When are you coming back? B: I'll be back by the evening.

Notes

"Itsu, modotte kuru no" is a casual way to ask when someone will return. "Itsu" means "when," "modotte" is the te-form of "modoru," meaning "to return," and "kuru" means "to come." Together, "modotte kuru" means returning toward the speaker's side or toward the place being treated as the base. The final "no" makes the question casual and slightly softer, asking for the other person's situation or plan. In this example, the speaker is not asking for an abstract time, but for the expected return point in an ongoing situation. "Itsu modotte kimasu ka" is a more formal version.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To ask when the other person will return to this place or to the original place.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

question expression

time check

schedule check

context-dependent expression

question-final no

spoken language

Watch out! It's coming!

あ！^{くるま}車、^き来てる！

A! Kuruma, kiteru!

Watch out! The car is coming!

Variants

- あ！車、来てる！
Watch out! The car is coming!
- 車、来てる！
Look out! A car is coming!
- 危ない、車！
Careful! There's a car!
- あ、来てる！
It's coming!
- 来てる来てる！
Here it comes!

Adjusted Expression

A 「あ、^{くるま}車が^きこちらに^き来ています。気をつけてください」 B 「^{あぶ}危ないですね」

A: A car is coming this way. Please be careful. B: That is dangerous.

Example

A 「あ！^{くるま}車、^き来てる！」 B 「^{あぶ}危ない！」

A: Watch out! The car is coming! B: Careful!

Notes

"A! Kuruma, kiteru!" is an immediate warning used when the speaker notices danger. "A!" is an interjection that marks sudden noticing or alarm. "Kuruma" names the approaching object, and "kiteru" is the contracted form of "kite iru," meaning "is coming." The expression is not arranged as a fully adjusted sentence such as "kuruma ga kite imasu." Instead, the speaker first reacts, then names the danger, and then gives the current movement. This order is well suited to real-time communication, where speed matters more than grammatical completeness.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To immediately warn someone when the speaker notices danger or something approaching.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

warning

attention-getting

context-dependent expression

contracted form

ellipsis

real-time communication

spoken language

Having to give up

それは、結局のところ、泣き寝入りです
ね

Sore wa, kekkyoku no tokoro, naki-neiri desu ne

So in the end, you just have to give up, don't you?

Variants

- 泣き寝入りですね
You just have to give up, don't you?
- 結局、泣き寝入りですね
There's nothing you can do, is there?
- それは泣き寝入りになりますね
You have no real recourse, do you?
- もう泣き寝入りするしかないですね
You are left with no choice but to let it go

Adjusted Expression

A 「銀行振り込みで商品が送られてこなくて、相手の住所もわからないんです」 B 「その場合、実際には相手を特定したり、返金を求めたりする手段がほとんどないため、損失を回収するのは難しいと思います」

A: I transferred the money to their account, but the product never came, and I do not even know where they are. B: In that case, since there is almost no practical way to identify the seller or demand a refund, it may be very difficult to recover the loss.

Example

- A 「銀行振り込みで商品が送ってこなくて、相手の住所もわからないんです」
B 「それは、結局のところ、泣き寝入りですね」

A: I transferred the money to their account, but the product never came, and I don't even know where they are. B: In the end, it sounds like you have no real recourse.

Notes

"Naki-neiri" describes a situation in which someone suffers a loss or injustice but has no effective way to complain, recover the loss, or pursue the matter further. Literally, the expression is built from "naki," from "naku," meaning "to cry," and "neiri," connected with falling asleep. However, in actual use it should be understood as a fixed expression. It does not simply mean enduring something silently. It implies that the person has been harmed but is forced to let the matter drop because no practical remedy is available. In this example, the speaker evaluates the situation after hearing that the money was transferred, the product did not arrive, and the seller cannot be located. The phrase is partly immediate as a reaction, but it can also function as an adjusted evaluation of the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To evaluate a situation as one in which someone has suffered a loss or harm but has no practical way to recover it or pursue the matter further.

Tags EN

immediate grammar contextually adjustive evaluation expression resignation loss
no available remedy spoken language

How's it going?

さいきん
最近、どう？

Saikin, dou?

How's it going?

Variants

- 最近、どう？
How's it going?
- 最近どうしてる？
How have you been?
- 最近、元気？
How have you been lately?
- 最近、調子どう？
How are things lately?
- 最近、どうですか？
How's everything going?

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{さいきん}最近は、どのように^す過ごしていますか？」 B 「^{げんき}元気になっています。ありがとうございます」

A: How have you been spending your time lately? B: I have been doing well. Thank you.

Example

A 「^{さいきん}最近、どう？」 B 「^{げんき}元気だよ、ありがとう」

A: How's it going lately? B: I'm good, thanks.

Notes

"Saikin, dou?" is a casual expression used to ask how someone has been lately. "Saikin" means "lately" or "recently," and "dou" means "how." The phrase is very short, but the missing part is supplied by the situation: "How have you been?", "How are things?", or "How is your life/work/study going?" In this sense, it is not merely an incomplete sentence. It works as a compact check-in expression. Because the speaker and listener share the situation, the short form is enough to open the conversation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

To casually ask someone how they have been or how things have been going lately.

Tags EN

immediate grammar

greeting

check-in

question expression

ellipsis

context-dependent expression

spoken language

I'm tired

あー、^{つか}疲れた

Aa, tsukareta

I'm tired

Variants

- あー、疲れた
I'm tired
- 疲れたー
I'm exhausted
- ほんと疲れた
I'm so tired
- もう疲れた
That wore me out
- ちょっと疲れた
I'm worn out

Adjusted Expression

A「今日は忙^{きょう}しかったですね」 B「はい、今日はかなり忙^{きょう}しかったですので、少し^{すこ}疲^{つか}れてしまいました」

A: Today was busy, wasn't it? B: Yes, it was quite busy, so I am a little tired now.

Example

A「今日は忙^{きょう}しかったですね」 B「あー、疲^{つか}れた」

A: Today was busy, wasn't it? B: Ah, I'm tired.

Notes

"Aa, tsukareta" is used when tiredness comes out as an immediate reaction. "Aa" is an interjection that carries the speaker's breath, feeling, or release of tension, and "tsukareta" is the past form of "tsukareru," meaning "to get tired." Although the form is past tense, the expression refers to the present state that has resulted from what happened before: the speaker is tired now. The subject is not stated because it is clear from the situation and from the speaker's bodily reaction. In this example, the speaker is not giving a careful report. The feeling of fatigue is simply released into speech.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

fatigue

frustration

Tags EN

immediate grammar

fatigue expression

emotional expression

interjection

state expression

ellipsis

spoken language

Isn't this amazing?

すご
凄くない？これ。

Sugoku nai? Kore.

Isn't this amazing?

Variants

- すごくない？これ
Isn't this amazing?
- これ、すごくない？
This is amazing, isn't it?
- すごくない？
Isn't it incredible?
- すごいよね、これ
This is amazing, right?
- やばくない？これ
Isn't this crazy?

Adjusted Expression

A 「これは^{せかいしんきろく}世界新記録です。とてもすごいことですね」

A: This is a world record. It is truly remarkable.

Example

A 「^{せかいしんきろく}世界新記録、^{すご}凄くない？これ」

A: It's a world record. Isn't this amazing?

Notes

"Sugoku nai? Kore" is used to express surprise, admiration, or excitement while inviting the listener to share the reaction. Although the expression contains "nai," it is not denying that something is amazing. Here, the negative question form works as a way to seek agreement or shared feeling, close to "Isn't this amazing?" in English. Grammatically, "sugoku" is the adverbial form of "sugoi," but in casual speech "sugoku nai?" functions almost as a fixed reaction pattern. The object "kore" comes after the reaction. A more adjusted order would be "kore, sugoku nai?" or "kore wa sugoi desu ne," but in the actual expression the emotional reaction comes first and the thing being evaluated is added afterward. This postposed "kore" gives the utterance a strong immediate quality.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

being impressed surprise seeking shared reaction

Tags EN

immediate grammar emotional expression surprise admiration negative question
seeking shared reaction postposing spoken language

Anything is fine

なんでもいいよ

Nandemo ii yo

Anything is fine

Variants

- なんでもいいよ
Anything is fine
- なんでもいい
Anything works for me
- どれでもいいよ
Whatever is fine
- どこでもいいよ
I'm fine with anything
- なんでも大丈夫
Any option is okay

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{なに}何がいいですか？」 B 「^{わたし}私は^{とく}特に^{きぼう}希望がないので、^{えら}どれを選んでもかまいません」

A: What would you like? B: I do not have any particular preference, so any option would be fine.

Example

A 「^{なに}何がいい？」 B 「なんでもいいよ」

A: What would you like? B: Anything is fine.

Notes

"Nandemo ii yo" is used when the speaker has no strong preference and is willing to accept any of the available options. "Nandemo" means "anything," "ii" means "good" or "fine," and the final "yo" lightly presents the speaker's stance to the listener. The expression can show flexibility, but it can also be risky. Depending on the situation, it may sound as if the speaker is not interested, does not want to think, or is leaving all the responsibility to the other person. This is especially true when the other person wants the speaker to show some preference or involvement. In that case, "nandemo ii yo" may not sound kind or flexible, but indifferent.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

leaving the choice to someone else

flexibility

no strong preference

Tags EN

immediate grammar

choice expression

entrusting expression

flexibility

may sound indifferent

context-dependent expression

spoken language

While listening to music

おんがく き
音楽、聞きながら...

Ongaku, kiki-nagara...

While listening to music...

Variants

- 音楽、聞きながら...
while listening to music
- 音楽を聞きながら
listening to music while...
- 聞きながら勉強してる
I'm studying while listening to music
- 音楽聞きながら勉強してる
with music on
- 何か聞きながらやってる
while doing something else

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{おんがく}音楽を^き聞きながら、^{べんきょう}勉強しています」 B 「いいですね」

A: I am studying while listening to music. B: That sounds nice.

Example

A 「^{おんがく}音楽、^き聞きながら、^{べんきょう}勉強してる」 B 「いいね」

A: I'm studying while listening to music. B: Nice.

Notes

"V-nagara" expresses that one action is carried out while another action is also taking place. The action before "nagara" is usually the accompanying or background action, and the following action is usually the main action. In this example, listening to music is the background action, and studying is the main action. The form attaches to the continuative form of the verb, not to the te-form: "kiku" becomes "kiki-nagara," not "kiite-nagara." In casual speech, the particle "o" after "ongaku" is often omitted, producing "ongaku, kiki-nagara." The speaker first places the activity or object in the scene and then continues into the action. This gives the expression a spoken, immediate quality.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

simultaneity

concurrent action

background action

Tags EN

immediate grammar

simultaneity

concurrent action

background action

particle omission

context-dependent expression

spoken language

Doing this and that

ね た
寝たり、食べたり

Netari, tabetari

Sleeping, eating, and so on

Variants

- 寝たり、食べたり
sleeping, eating, and so on
- 食べたり、寝たり
doing things like sleeping and eating
- 寝たり食べたりしてる
sleeping, eating, that kind of thing
- ごろごろしたり、寝たりしてる
just sleeping, eating, and stuff
- いろいろしてる
doing this and that

Adjusted Expression

A 「休^{やす}みの日^ひは、何^{なに}をしていますか？」 B 「休^{やす}みの日^ひは、寝^ねたり、食^たべたりしています」

A: What do you do on your days off? B: On my days off, I do things like sleep and eat.

Example

A 「休^{やす}みの日^ひは、何^{なに}してるの？」 B 「寝^ねたり、食^たべたりしてる」

A: What do you do on your days off? B: I sleep, eat, and so on.

Notes

"V-tari, V-tari" is used to list representative actions without presenting a complete list. It is formed by attaching "tari" to the past form of verbs, such as "neta ri" from "neru" and "tabeta ri" from "taberu." The expression does not mean that only those actions are done, nor does it aim to list everything. Instead, it gives a few typical examples and leaves the rest understood. In this example, the speaker answers casually by naming a couple of ordinary activities, suggesting a loose, unstructured way of spending the day.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

giving representative examples non-exhaustive listing describing everyday activity

Tags EN

immediate grammar listing expression exemplification non-exhaustive listing
repetitive construction context-dependent expression spoken language

Finally

やっと、だよ

Yatto, da yo

Finally

Variants

- やっと、だよ

Finally

- やっとだよ

Finally, it's done

- やっと終わったよ

Not already, finally

- もう、じゃなくて、やっと

It finally got done

- やっと終わった

I finally finished it

Adjusted Expression

A 「宿題^{しゅくだい}は、もう終わ^おったのですか？」 B 「早く^{はや}終わ^おったのではなく、ようやく^{ようやく}終わったところです」

A: Have you already finished your homework? B: It is not that I finished it quickly. I have only just finally finished it.

Example

A 「宿題^{しゅくだい}、もう終わ^おったの？」 B 「もう、じゃなくて、やっと、だよ」

A: You done with your homework already? B: Not already. Finally!

Notes

"Yatto, da yo" expresses that something has finally happened after time, effort, delay, or difficulty. "Yatto" means "finally" or "at last," and the final "da yo" presents the speaker's correction or emphasis to the listener. In this example, the important contrast is between "mou" and "yatto." The first speaker says "mou owatta no?", which suggests that the homework was finished sooner than expected. The second speaker rejects that framing and says "mou, ja nakute, yatto, da yo." The speaker is saying that it was not quick at all; it took effort and has only now finally been completed. The sentence is short and elliptical, but the contrast carries the feeling of fatigue, relief, and mild protest.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

achievement completion relief correction

Tags EN

immediate grammar completion expression sense of achievement relief
correction expression ellipsis spoken language

Is that so?

そうなの？

Sou na no?

Is that so?

Variants

- そうなの？
Is that so?
- そうなんだ？
Really?
- そうなのかな
Is that right?
- そうじゃないと思うけど
I don't think so
- そうではないと思います
I don't think that's the case

Adjusted Expression

A 「明日、試験あす しけんですね」 B 「そうなんですか？ただ、私わたしはそうではないと思おもいます」

A: The exam is tomorrow, right? B: Is that so? I do not think that is the case, though.

Example

A 「明日、試験あす しけんだよ」 B 「そうなの？ じゃないと思おもうけど」

A: The exam is tomorrow, right? B: Is that so? I don't think so, though.

Notes

"Sou na no?" is a casual expression used to react to information by asking whether it is really so. "Sou" refers to the content just mentioned, and "na no?" makes it into a soft question. Depending on the tone, it can express confirmation, mild surprise, curiosity, or doubt. In this example, the speaker does not simply accept the information. After saying "sou na no?", the speaker adds "ja nai to omou kedo," meaning "I don't think so, though." The part before "ja nai" is omitted because it is already available from the previous utterance. The speaker first reacts to the information and then immediately checks it against their own understanding.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

confirmation

question

mild surprise

checking against one's understanding

Tags EN

immediate grammar

confirmation expression

question expression

mild surprise

checking against one's understanding

sentence-final particle

spoken language

How about coffee sometime?

こんど、のんびり、コーヒーでもどう？

Kondo, nonbiri, koohii demo dou?

How about coffee sometime?

Variants

- 今度、のんびり、コーヒーでもどう？

How about coffee sometime?

- 今度、コーヒーでもどう？

How about having coffee sometime?

- 今度、お茶でもどう？

Let's have coffee sometime

- また今度、ゆっくり話そう

Let's take it easy over coffee sometime

- 今度、時間あるときにでも

We should catch up sometime

Adjusted Expression

A 「今度、時間があるときに、ゆっくりコーヒーでも飲みませんか？」 B 「いいですね」

A: Would you like to have coffee together sometime when you have time?

B: That sounds good.

Example

A 「今度、のんびり、コーヒーでもどう？」 B 「いいね」

A: How about coffee sometime, just to take it easy? B: Sounds good.

Notes

"Kondo, nonbiri, koohii demo dou?" is a casual invitation. "Kondo" means "sometime" or "next time," "nonbiri" gives the feeling of relaxing or taking things slowly, and "koohii demo" presents coffee as a light option rather than a fixed plan. The final "dou?" makes it a suggestion: "How about...?" The expression does not force a concrete schedule. It gently opens the possibility of meeting. Because of this, it can be a real invitation, but it can also work as a courteous social remark. If the invitation is serious, rejecting it too sharply may sound cold. If it is only a social remark, pressing the person for a date immediately may feel too direct. The expression is therefore highly dependent on the relationship, tone, and situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

suggestion invitation social approach

Tags EN

immediate grammar invitation expression suggestion expression softening expression
courteous social remark context-dependent expression spoken language

Let's go home

かえ
帰ろ

Kaero

Let's go home

Variants

- 帰ろ
Let's go home
- 帰ろう
Let's head home
- いっしょに帰ろ
Let's go back
- もう帰ろ
Let's go home together
- そろそろ帰ろ
Let's get going

Adjusted Expression

A 「いっしょに^{かえ}帰りましょう」 B 「はい、^{かえ}帰りましょう」

A: Shall we go home together? B: Yes, let's go home.

Example

A 「いっしょに^{かえ}帰ろ」 B 「うん、^{かえ}帰ろう」

A: Let's go home together. B: Yeah, let's go.

Notes

"Kaero" is a casual shortened form of "kaerou," the volitional form of "kaeru," meaning "to go home" or "to return." It is used to suggest going home or leaving, often with the listener. In this example, "issho ni kaero" means "let's go home together." The full form "kaerou" is also casual, but "kaero" is even shorter and more immediate. The speaker does not explain the reason for leaving. The shared situation supplies it: it may be late, the activity may be over, or both people may already be ready to leave. The short form works because the decision and movement are being formed in the moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

going home

suggestion

joint action

Tags EN

immediate grammar

invitation expression

suggestion expression

volitional form

contracted expression

context-dependent expression

spoken language

Let's stop somewhere on the way home

よ みち
寄り道して

Yorimichi shite

stop somewhere on the way

Variants

- 寄り道して
Let's stop somewhere on the way home
- 寄り道して帰ろ
Let's make a stop on the way home
- ちょっと寄り道しよう
Let's take a little detour
- どこか寄って帰ろ
Let's go somewhere before heading home
- 帰りにどこか寄ろう
Let's stop by somewhere before we go home

Adjusted Expression

A 「帰る^{かえ}前^{まえ}に、どこかへ少し^{すこ}寄^よってから帰^{かえ}りましょう」 B 「いいですね」

A: Before we go home, let's stop somewhere for a little while. B: That sounds good.

Example

A 「寄^より道^{みち}して、帰^{かえ}ろ」 B 「いいね」

A: Let's stop somewhere on the way home. B: Sounds good.

Notes

"Yorimichi shite" means making a stop or taking a small detour on the way to one's destination, especially on the way home. In the example "yorimichi shite, kaero," the speaker suggests not going straight home, but stopping somewhere first. The expression is casual and often has a light, enjoyable feeling, such as stopping at a shop, cafe, park, or other place along the way. "Yorimichi" literally suggests leaving the direct route, but in English "take a detour" can sound more like a route change. In this context, "stop somewhere on the way home" is often more natural. The te-form "shite" links the side action, stopping somewhere, with the main action, going home.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

suggestion

invitation

change of plan

Tags EN

immediate grammar

invitation expression

suggestion expression

change of plan

movement expression

context-dependent expression

spoken language

Basically

きほんてき
基本的には

Kihonteki ni wa

Basically

Variants

- 基本的には
Basically
- 基本的には賛成です
Basically, I agree
- 基本的にはそう思います
In principle, I agree
- 大筋では賛成です
Broadly speaking, I agree
- 原則としては賛成です
As a basic position, I agree

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{きほんてき}基本的な^{たちば}立場としては^{さんせい}賛成ですが、いくつか^{かくにん}確認したい^{てん}点があります」 B
「^{なに}ということは、何か^{もんだい}問題があるということですか？」

A: As a basic position, I agree, but there are a few points I would like to confirm. B: So, does that mean there is some kind of problem?

Example

A 「^{きほんてき}基本的には、^{さんせい}賛成です」 B 「^{なに}ということは、何か^{もんだい}問題でも？」

A: Basically, I agree. B: So, is there a problem?

Notes

"Kihonteki ni wa" means "basically," "in principle," or "as a basic position." It is placed before the main statement and frames how that statement should be understood. In the example "kihonteki ni wa, sansei desu," the speaker is saying that they agree at the basic level, but the expression also leaves room for reservations, conditions, or problems in the details. This is why the listener responds, "So, is there a problem?" The phrase does not change the grammar of the main clause "sansei desu," but it changes how the utterance is heard. In this sense, it works as an extrasyntactic preposed phrase: it stands before the main structure and marks the speaker's stance, viewpoint, or degree of commitment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- framing
- evaluation
- reservation
- basic stance

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- framing expression
- reservation expression
- evaluation expression
- extrasyntactic preposed phrase
- stance marking
- spoken language

Thank you for coming

き
来てくれてありがとう

Kite kurete arigatou

Thank you for coming

Variants

- 来てくれてありがとう
Thank you for coming
- 来てくれてありがと
Thanks for coming
- 来てくれてうれしい
I'm glad you came
- 来てくださってありがとうございます
Thank you for being here
- 来てくださり、ありがとうございます
Thank you for taking the time to come

Adjusted Expression

A 「本日は来てくださり、ありがとうございます」 B 「こちらこそ、呼んでくださり、ありがとうございます」

A: Thank you for coming today. B: Thank you as well for inviting me.

Example

A 「来てくれてありがとう」 B 「いえいえ、呼んでくれてありがとう」

A: Thank you for coming. B: No, thank you for inviting me.

Notes

"Kite kurete arigatou" is a casual expression used to thank someone for coming. "Kite" is the te-form of "kuru," meaning "to come," and "kurete" shows that the action was done for the speaker's benefit or was received by the speaker as something welcome. The expression is therefore not just a report that the person came. It presents the other person's coming as something the speaker appreciates. In the example, B replies with "yonde kurete arigatou," meaning "thank you for inviting me." The two expressions mirror each other: one side thanks the person for coming, and the other thanks the person for inviting them. The more polite form is "kite kudasari, arigatou gozaimasu" or "kite kudasatte arigatou gozaimasu."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

gratitude

thanks for coming

thanks for participation

benefactive expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

gratitude expression

benefactive expression

thanks for coming

thanks for participation

formulaic expression

spoken language

Oh, stop it.

ちょっと、やめてよ

Chotto, yamete yo

Oh, stop it.

Variants

- やめてよ

Oh, stop it.

- ちょっと、やめてよ

Stop it.

- やめて

Cut it out.

- やめてください

Please stop.

Adjusted Expression

A 「今日は髪型^{きょう かみがた}がすてきですね」 B 「そういうことを言うのは、やめてください」

A: Your hairstyle looks lovely today. B: Please don't say things like that.

Example

A 「今日は髪型^{きょう かみがた}、すてきだね」 B 「ちょっと、やめてよ」

A: Your hairstyle looks great today. B: Oh, stop it.

Notes

"Chotto, yamete yo" is a casual expression used to tell someone to stop, but the force of the expression depends heavily on the situation.

"Yamete" is the te-form of "yameru," meaning "to stop," and the final "yo" adds emotional force. In this example, however, the speaker is not seriously ordering the other person to stop harmful behavior. The speaker has just been complimented and reacts with embarrassment.

"Chotto" here does not literally mean "a little." It works as an emotional preface, softening the utterance while also showing surprise or fluster. In this context, "Oh, stop it" is more natural than a stronger expression like "Cut it out." Depending on tone, the same phrase can express real refusal, playful embarrassment, or joking protest.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

refusal

emotion

embarrassment

joking

Tags EN

immediate grammar

emotional expression

embarrassment

reaction expression

refusal expression

context-dependent expression

spoken language

What should I do?

どうすればいい？

Dou sureba ii?

What should I do?

Variants

- どうすればいい

What should I do?

- どうすればいい？

What can I do?

- どうしたらいい

What do I do?

- どうしよう

What am I supposed to do?

- どうする

What now?

- どしたらいい

Adjusted Expression

A 「ああ、もう時間^{じかん}がありません。この場合^{ばあい}、どうすればよいでしょうか？」

B 「まず、少し^{すこ}落ち着^おいてください」

A: Oh no, there is no time left. What should I do in this situation? B: First, please calm down a little.

Example

A 「ああ、もう時間じかんがない、どうすればいい？」 B 「ちょっと、落ちおついて」

A: Oh no, there's no time left. What should I do? B: Calm down a bit.

Notes

"Dou sureba ii?" is used when the speaker is unsure what action to take and asks for advice, help, or judgment. "Dou" means "how" or "what way," "sureba" is the conditional form of "suru," meaning "if I do," and "ii" means "good" or "right." The expression literally has the shape "If I do how, is it good?" but in conversation it functions as "What should I do?" In this example, the speaker reacts to the lack of time and immediately asks for a way forward. The expression can be directed to another person, but it can also be used as self-talk when the speaker is panicking or trying to decide what to do. "Dou shiyoi" is close, but it sounds more like "What am I going to do?" or "What should I do now?" while "dou sureba ii" more directly asks for a suitable course of action.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

confusion

asking for advice

seeking help

asking for judgment

Tags EN

immediate grammar

consultation expression

confusion expression

asking for advice

asking for judgment

question expression

context-dependent expression

spoken language

It defeats the purpose

もと こ
元も子もない

Moto mo ko mo nai

It defeats the purpose

Variants

- 元も子もない

It defeats the purpose

- だい
台なし

That would ruin everything

- すべてがみず あわ
水の泡

There would be nothing left

- それでは意味がない

It would all be for nothing

- 本末転倒

That would be counterproductive

Adjusted Expression

A 「むり 無理をしてはいけません。からだ こわ 体を壊してしまったら、そもそものもくてき うしな 目的が失われてしまいます」

A: You should not overdo it. If you damage your health, the original purpose will be lost.

Example

A 「むり 無理しちゃいけない。からだ こわ 体を壊したらもと こ 元も子もない」

A: Don't overdo it. If you ruin your health, it defeats the whole purpose.

Notes

"Moto mo ko mo nai" is used when an action meant to achieve something would end up destroying the very basis or purpose of that action. "Moto" refers to the original source, basis, or principal, and "ko" refers to what comes from it, such as profit, result, or offspring. In actual use, the phrase works as a fixed expression meaning that everything would be lost, or that the action would defeat the purpose. In this example, working hard may be good, but if the person damages their health, the original goal loses its meaning. The expression is often used as a warning: do not sacrifice the foundation in order to pursue the result.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

warning

defeating the purpose

avoiding loss

loss of purpose

Tags EN

immediate grammar

warning expression

evaluation expression

defeating the purpose

avoiding loss

negative expression

spoken language

No way

わけ
な訳ないでしょ

Na wake nai desho

No way

Variants

- な訳ないでしょ

No way

- そんな訳ないでしょ

Come on

- そんなことないでしょ

That's impossible

- ありえないでしょ

That can't be true

- まさか

Don't be silly

Adjusted Expression

A 「あの人は、実は^{ひと}宇宙人^{じつ うちゅうじん}なのではありませんか？」 B 「そのようなことはな
い^{おも}と思います。漫画^{まんが}の読み^よすぎではないでしょうか」

A: Could that person actually be an alien? B: I do not think that is the case. Perhaps you have been reading too many comics.

Example

A 「あの^{ひと}人、^{じつ}実は^{うちゅうじん}宇宙人なんじゃない？」 B 「^{わけ}な訳ないでしょ！^{まんが}漫画の^よ読みすぎ！」

A: That person is actually an alien, right? B: No way! You've been reading too many comics!

Notes

"Na wake nai desho" is a casual expression used to strongly reject an unlikely idea or guess. It is best understood as a shortened form of "sonna wake nai desho," meaning "there is no reason or possibility for that to be true." "Wake" here does not mean a physical reason that is being explained. It refers to the grounds, possibility, or logic by which something could be the case. The final "desho" adds the sense that the listener should also recognize this. In the example, the speaker immediately rejects the idea that the person is an alien and then adds "manga no yomisugi," meaning "you've been reading too many comics." The denial comes first as a quick reaction, and the reason or teasing comment follows.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

negation surprise objection rejecting an unlikely guess

Tags EN

immediate grammar negative expression reaction expression surprise objection
denial of possibility spoken language

Surely

きっと、^{せいかい}正解

Kitto, seikai

Surely, this is right

Variants

- きっと
surely
- きっと正解
I'm sure this is right
- きっとこれだ
This must be right
- たぶんこれだ
This is probably right
- おそらくこれだ
This is likely the answer

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{せいかい}正解は、おそらくこれだ^{おも}と思います」 B 「ええ、^{わたし}私も^{おも}そうだと思います」

A: I think this is probably the correct answer. B: Yes, I think so too.

Example

A 「^{せいかい}正解は、きっと、これだ」 B 「きっと、そうだね」

A: I'm sure this is the answer. B: Yes, I'm sure it is.

Notes

"Kitto" expresses confidence, expectation, or a strong guess. It is often translated as "surely," "I'm sure," or sometimes "probably," depending on the situation. It does not mean that the speaker has fully confirmed the fact. Rather, the speaker presents the judgment as something they strongly expect to be true. In the example, "seikai wa, kitto, kore da" means that the speaker believes this is the correct answer, even though the answer may not yet be officially confirmed. The short expression "kitto, seikai" leaves out parts such as "da" or "to omou," but the situation supplies them. "Kitto" is different from "tashika ni." "Tashika ni" usually confirms or acknowledges something, while "kitto" points toward expectation, prediction, or confidence before full confirmation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

confidence prediction expectation self-confirmation

Tags EN

immediate grammar confidence expression inference expression prediction expression
self-confirmation ellipsis spoken language

I mean

て言うか、^ち^ゃ^ん^すチャンスがないっていうか、

...

Te iu ka, chansu ga nai tte iu ka, ...

I mean, there are no opportunities...

Variants

- て言うか

I mean

- っていうか

or rather

- というか

more like

- というより

not exactly

- じゃなくて

rather

- むしろ

what I mean is

Adjusted Expression

A 「いい^{しごと}仕事がないのですか？」 B 「そういうことではなく、そもそも^{きかい}機会
^{じたい}自体がほとんどないということです」

A: Are there no good jobs? B: It is not quite that. What I mean is that there are hardly any opportunities in the first place.

Example

A 「いい^{しごと}がないの？」 B 「て^い言うか、そもそも^{ちやんすじたい}チャンス自体がないっていうか、 ...」

A: Are there no good jobs? B: I mean, there aren't even any opportunities in the first place...

Notes

"Te iu ka" is a casual expression used when the speaker adjusts, corrects, or reframes what has just been said. It can be translated as "I mean," "or rather," or "more like," depending on the context. In this example, A asks whether there are no good jobs. B does not simply answer that question. Instead, B begins with "te iu ka" and shifts the frame: the issue is not whether there are good jobs, but that there are no opportunities in the first place. The second "tte iu ka" leaves the utterance slightly unfinished, as if the speaker is still searching for the best way to state the problem. "Somosomo" resets the premise, and "jitai" focuses on the opportunity itself. Together, they support the speaker's real-time adjustment of the explanation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- rephrasing
- correcting an explanation
- focus adjustment
- reframing the premise

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- rephrasing expression
- correcting an explanation
- focus adjustment
- reframing the premise
- unfinished utterance
- spoken language

It's up to you

じぶんしだい
自分次第

Jibun shidai

It's up to you

Variants

- じぶんしだい
自分次第

It's up to you

- あなたしだい
あなた次第

It's your choice

- きみしだい
君次第

It's your decision

- ほんにんしだい
本人次第

It depends on you

- きもしだい
気持ち次第

It depends on how you feel

Adjusted Expression

それをやるかどうかは、ほんにん ほんだん きも
本人の判断と気持ちにかかっています。

Whether to do it or not depends on the person's own judgment and feelings.

Example

それをやるかどうかは、じぶんしだい
自分次第。

Whether to do it or not is up to you.

Notes

"Jibun shidai" means that the choice, decision, outcome, or future course depends on oneself. "Jibun" means "oneself," and "shidai" means "depending on" or "being determined by." The expression can be used when leaving a decision to someone, but it can also be used when talking about one's own effort, attitude, or motivation. In this example, whether to do it or not is not presented as something decided by others. It is framed as something that depends on the person's own will and judgment. The phrase can sound encouraging, but it can also carry responsibility: if it is up to you, the result may also depend on you.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

choice decision responsibility self-determination

Tags EN

immediate grammar choice expression decision expression responsibility expression
self-determination context-dependent expression spoken language

In the blink of an eye

あっという間に

A tto iu ma ni

In the blink of an eye

Variants

- あっという間に
in the blink of an eye
- たちまち
in an instant
- 一瞬のうちに
in no time
- 瞬く間に
before I knew it
- 気づいたらもう
just like that

Adjusted Expression

A 「おいしかったですか？」 B 「はい、とてもおいしかったので、短い時間で全部食べてしまいました」

A: Was it delicious? B: Yes, it was so delicious that I ate all of it very quickly.

Example

A 「おいしかった？」 B 「あっという間に、食べちゃった」

A: Was it delicious? B: I ate it before I knew it.

Notes

"Atto iu ma ni" expresses that something happened or was completed so quickly that it felt almost instantaneous. The expression comes from the idea that the time was as short as the moment it takes to say "a!" or "ah!" In actual conversation, it is not just an objective measure of speed. It often conveys the speaker's felt experience: before the speaker fully noticed it, the action was already finished. In this example, "atto iu ma ni, tabechatta" means that the speaker ate it very quickly, probably because it was delicious. The ending "tabechatta" also adds the feeling that the action was completed before one quite realized it. In English, "I ate it before I knew it" is more natural here than the literal "In the blink of an eye, I ate it."

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

sense of time short duration completion surprise

Tags EN

immediate grammar time expression felt time short-duration expression
completion expression surprise spoken language

That was thoughtful

き き
気が利いてる！

Ki ga kiiteru!

That was thoughtful

Variants

- き き
気が利いてる

That was thoughtful

- き き
気が利いてるね

How thoughtful

- よく き き
気が利く

That's considerate

- き
気がまわる

You're so attentive

- き く ば
気配りがある

That was really nice

Adjusted Expression

A 「あ、こーひーにちょこれーとがついていますね」 B 「こういうちいこころづかい
は、とてもき きが利いていますね」

A: Oh, there is a piece of chocolate with the coffee. B: This kind of small gesture is very thoughtful.

Example

A 「あ、^{こーひー}に^{ちょこ}れーとがついてる！」 B 「ちょっと、^きが^き利いてるね」

A: Oh, there is a piece of chocolate with the coffee! B: That's a nice little thoughtful touch.

Notes

"Ki ga kiiteru" is used to praise a thoughtful action, arrangement, or small gesture that shows attention to the situation. "Ki" refers to awareness, attention, or sensitivity to what is needed, and "kiiteru" here means that this awareness is working well. The expression is often used when someone has noticed what would please or help others before being asked. In this example, the chocolate served with coffee is not necessary, but it creates a small pleasant surprise. The speaker reacts to that small act of consideration by saying "ki ga kiiteru." The expression can be said directly to the person responsible, but it can also be said to someone nearby, in a way that lets the praise be heard indirectly. That indirectness can make the praise feel more natural and less forced.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

praise

appreciation

evaluation

reaction to thoughtfulness

Tags EN

immediate grammar

evaluation expression

praise expression

gratitude expression

thoughtfulness

reaction expression

spoken language

Well, then

さて、...

Sate, ...

Well, then...

Variants

- さて、...
Well, then...
- さて、それでは
Now, ...
- それでは、...
All right, ...
- では、...
Then, ...
- じゃあ、...
So, ...

Adjusted Expression

A 「それでは、^{つぎ} ^{ないよう} ^{うつ} 次の内容に移ります。まずはじめに、^{もんだい} ^{ていじ} 問題を提示します」

A: Now, let us move on to the next part. First, I will present a question.

Example

A 「さて、まずはじめに、^{もんだい} 問題です」

A: Well, then, first of all, here is a question.

Notes

"Sate" is a discourse marker used when the speaker shifts the scene, opens a new part of the talk, or moves the interaction forward. It can be translated as "well," "now," or "well, then," depending on the context. The expression does not add much propositional content by itself. Instead, it organizes the flow of speech. In the example, the speaker says "sate" before introducing the first question. This signals that the previous situation is being closed or set aside, and that the next activity is about to begin. "Soredewa" and "dewa" are more formal or more clearly transitional, while "jaa" is more casual.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

topic shift

opening

discourse management

scene transition

Tags EN

immediate grammar

discourse marker

topic shift

opening expression

discourse management

scene transition

spoken language

Not yet

いえいえ、まだまだ、...

Ie ie, mada mada, ...

Not yet

Variants

- いえいえ、まだまだ
Oh no, not at all
- いえいえ、そんな
I'm still learning
- まだまだですよ
Not even close
- いやいや、全然です
I'm flattered, but no
- いえ、私なんてまだまだ
Far from it
- とんでもないです
I'm not there yet
- まだまだ未熟で
I have a long way to go
- とても及びません
You're too kind

Adjusted Expression

A 「ピアノがとてもお上手ですね」 B 「いえ、そのようなことはありません。
まだまだ練習が必要です」

A: You are very good at piano. B: No, not really. I still need much more practice.

Example

A 「ピアノ、お上手ですね」 B 「いえいえ、まだまだ...」

A: You're good at piano. B: Oh no, I'm still far from that...

Notes

"Te ie, mada mada" is used as an immediate modest response to praise. "Te ie" repeats "no" and lightly pushes back against the compliment. "Mada mada" means "not yet" or "still far from enough," and it presents the speaker as still learning or not yet fully skilled. In the example, the speaker does not directly accept the compliment "You are good at piano." Instead, the speaker lowers the self-evaluation by saying "ie ie, mada mada." This kind of expression can be sincere, ritual modesty, or playful self-deprecation, depending on the relationship and tone. It is also possible for someone to say "ie ie, mada mada" and then immediately show impressive skill. In that case, the modesty itself becomes part of the performance.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

modesty negation response to praise downplaying self-evaluation

Tags EN

immediate grammar modesty expression negative expression response to praise
self-evaluation repetition spoken language

Without thinking

おも
思わず、...

Omowazu, ...

Without thinking

Variants

- おも
思わず
without thinking
- つい
instinctively
- むいしき
無意識に
unconsciously
- むいしき
無意識のうちに
reflexively
- はんしゃてき
反射的に
before I knew it
- とっさ
咄嗟に
on impulse
- かんが
考えずに

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{じゅうぶん}十分に^{かんが}考えずに、^{ほんとう}本当のことを^い言ってしまった」

A: I said the truth without thinking it through carefully.

Example

A 「^{おも}思わず、^{ほんとう}本当のこと、^い言っちゃった」

A: I said the truth without thinking.

Notes

"Omowazu" describes an action or utterance that comes out before conscious thought or deliberate control. It suggests that the speaker did not first think carefully and then act. Instead, the reaction came first. In the example "omowazu, hontou no koto, icchatta," the speaker says that they ended up saying the truth even though they may not have intended to. The ending "icchatta" adds the sense that the action has already happened and cannot be taken back. The speaker may later regret it, but the expression can also describe a moment when someone blurts out what others were secretly thinking. The immediate quality lies in the order: the reaction comes out first, and awareness or reflection follows afterward.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

immediate reaction unconscious action emotion regret explaining an action

Tags EN

immediate grammar reaction expression unconscious action emotional expression

split-second action regret spoken language

I can do it

い 行ける、い 行ける

Ikeru, ikeru

I can do it

Variants

- い 行ける、い 行ける

I can do it

- い 行ける

I can make it

- できる

It's doable

- やれる

I'm good

- だいじょうぶ 大丈夫

It's okay

- なんとかなる

I can handle it

Adjusted Expression

A 「できますか？」 B 「はい、できると思います。問題ありません」

A: Can you do it? B: Yes, I think I can do it. There should be no problem.

Example

A 「い 行ける？」 B 「い 行ける、い 行ける」

A: Can you do it? B: Yeah, I can do it.

Notes

"Ikeru, ikeru" is a casual expression used to say that something is possible, manageable, or all right. Although "ikeru" comes from "iku," meaning "to go," it is often used beyond physical movement. Depending on the situation, it can mean "I can do it," "I can make it," "It's doable," or "It's okay." In this example, A asks "ikeru?" and B repeats "ikeru, ikeru." The repetition gives the answer a quick reassuring force, as if the speaker is saying, "Yes, it's fine, no problem." The expression can be used to reassure oneself, to reassure another person, or to encourage someone. It is highly context-dependent because what is possible or manageable is supplied by the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

judging possibility

encouragement

self-confirmation

sharing reassurance

Tags EN

immediate grammar

possibility expression

encouragement expression

self-confirmation

sharing reassurance

repetition

spoken language

But

でも、 ...

Demo, ...

But ...

Variants

- でも、 ...

But ...

- けど、 ...

Still ...

- けど、 ...

Though ...

- でもね、 ...

That said, ...

- とはいえ、 ...

Even so, ...

- それでも、 ...

However ...

- しかし、 ...

Adjusted Expression

A 「おいしいですね」 B 「たしかにおいしいですが、^み^め見た目はあまりきれいではありません」

A: It is delicious. B: It is certainly delicious, but it does not look very good.

Example

A 「おいしいね」 B 「でも、あまり、^み見た^め目がきれいじゃない」

A: It's delicious. B: But it doesn't look very good.

Notes

"Demo" is a casual expression used to introduce a contrast, reservation, or shift in direction. It is often translated as "but." In this example, B is not completely rejecting A's statement that the food is delicious. Instead, B accepts or leaves that evaluation in place and adds another point: the appearance is not very good. In this way, "demo" opens a new evaluation axis. It lets the speaker move from one aspect of the situation to another. Compared with "shikashi," "demo" is shorter, softer, and more common in casual conversation. It can be used for disagreement, but it can also be used simply to add a different angle.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

contrast

adversative connection

adding an evaluation

shifting direction

Tags EN

immediate grammar

adversative expression

contrast expression

adding an evaluation

shifting direction

discourse marker

spoken language

It all worked out in the end

けっか おーらい
結果、オーライ

Kekka, oorai

It all worked out in the end

Variants

- けっか おーらい
結果、オーライ

It all worked out in the end

- まあ、なんとかなった

All good in the end

- なんとかうまくいった

It turned out all right

- うまくいった

It worked out

- お
終わりよければすべてよし

All's well that ends well

-

We made it

Adjusted Expression

A 「いろいろ^{たいへん}大変でしたね」 B 「たしかに^{とちゅう}途中はいろいろありましたが、
^{さいしゅうでき}最終的にはうまくいったので、よかった^{おも}と思います」

A: It was tough, wasn't it? B: Yes, a lot happened along the way, but in the end it worked out, so I think it was fine.

Example

A 「いろいろ^{たいへん}大変だったね」 B 「結果^{けっか}、オーライ^{おーらい}ですよ」

A: It was tough, wasn't it? B: It all worked out in the end.

Notes

"Kekka, oorai" is a casual expression used when things were difficult or messy along the way, but the final result was acceptable or good. "Kekka" means "result" or "outcome," and "oorai" comes from "all right." The expression does not deny that there were problems. Rather, it looks back from the final result and says that, since things ended well enough, the whole situation can be accepted. It often carries relief, lightness, and a sense of closure. In English, "It all worked out in the end" or "All's well that ends well" is more natural than a literal "Result, all right." The phrase can also be used jokingly or optimistically, even when the trouble was not very serious.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

evaluating the result resolution relief closure

Tags EN

immediate grammar result evaluation relief expression resolution expression
closure expression light summary spoken language

Show me

^み
見せて、...

Misete, ...

Show me

Variants

- ^み
見せて

Show me

- ちょっと^み
見せて

Let me see

- ^み
見せてくれる？

Can I see?

- ^み
見せてよ

Can I take a look?

- ^み
見せてください

Let me have a look

Adjusted Expression

A 「これは^{あた}ら^{ほん}新しい本ですか。よろしければ、^{すこ}^み少し見せてください」

A: Is this a new book? If you do not mind, please let me take a look.

Example

A 「これ、^{あた}ら^{ほん}新しい本？^みちょっと見せて」

A: Is this a new book? Let me see it.

Notes

"Misete" is a casual expression used to ask someone to show something or let the speaker look at it. It is the te-form of "miseru," meaning "to show." Although it can sound direct, it is not the same as a bare imperative. In casual conversation, the te-form can work as a short request. In the example, the speaker first notices the book and asks, "Is this a new book?" Then "chotto misete" follows as an immediate request to look at it. "Chotto" softens the request and makes it sound less abrupt. Depending on tone and relationship, "misete" can sound friendly, curious, childish, or pushy.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

request

checking

interest

requesting visual access

Tags EN

immediate grammar

request expression

checking expression

interest expression

gaze direction

te-form request

spoken language

There's always next time

つぎ
次がある

Tsugi ga aru

There's always next time

Variants

- 次がある

There's always next time

- 次があるよ

You can try again

- 次があるさ

You'll get another chance

- またチャンスあるよ

Better luck next time

- また今度がある

Next time for sure

- 今度こそ

Adjusted Expression

A 「失敗してしまいました」 B 「今回は残念でしたが、また機会があります」

A: I failed. B: This time was unfortunate, but there will be another opportunity.

Example

A 「失敗しちゃった」 B 「次があるよ」

A: I messed up. B: There's always next time.

Notes

"Tsugi ga aru" is used to comfort or encourage someone after a failure, disappointment, or missed chance. Literally, it means "there is a next one," but in conversation it means that the present failure is not the end. The speaker points to a future opportunity and helps the listener move away from the current disappointment. In the example, A says "shippai shichatta," using "chara" to show that the failure has already happened and feels regrettable. B answers "tsugi ga aru yo," not by analyzing the failure, but by immediately opening a future possibility. The final "yo" gently presents that reassurance to the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

encouragement

comfort

trying again

support after failure

Tags EN

immediate grammar

encouragement expression

comfort expression

trying again

response to failure

sharing reassurance

spoken language

It's your turn

きみ ばん
君の番だよ

Kimi no ban da yo

It's your turn

Variants

- きみ ばん
君の番だよ

It's your turn

- つぎ きみ
次は君だよ

You're up

- きみ でばん
君の出番だよ

Now it's your turn

- あなたのばん
あなたの番ですよ

Your move

- つぎ
次はあなたですよ

You're next

Adjusted Expression

A 「つぎ あなたのばん
次はあなたの番です」 B 「わ
分かっています」

A: Next, it is your turn. B: I understand.

Example

A 「きみ ばん
君の番だよ」 B 「わ
分かってるよ」

A: It's your turn. B: I know.

Notes

"Kimi no ban da yo" is a casual expression used to tell someone that it is their turn to act. "Kimi" means "you," and "ban" means one's turn in an order. The final "da yo" presents the information directly and lightly to the listener. In the example, A is not explaining the whole situation. The shared setting already makes clear what kind of turn it is: a game, a task, a performance, a reply, or some other action. A only needs to say "kimi no ban da yo" to move the interaction forward. B's reply, "wakatte ru yo," shows that the timing had already been recognized, or that B feels a little pushed.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

indicating the turn

prompting action

handover

indicating timing

Tags EN

immediate grammar

turn indication

prompting expression

handover expression

timing indication

context-dependent expression

spoken language

That's the plan

そのつもり

Sono tsumori

That's the plan

Variants

- そのつもり
That's the plan
- ええ、そのつもり
That's what I intend to do
- もちろん、そのつもり
Yeah, I will
- うん、そのつもり
Of course I will
- ちゃんとそのつもり
Sure, I will
- ばっちりそのつもり
Yes, that's what I plan to do
- はい、そのつもりです
Yes, I intend to

Adjusted Expression

A 「明日も練習あす れんしゅうしますか？」 B 「はい、明日も練習あす れんしゅうするつもりでいます」

A: Will you practice tomorrow too? B: Yes, I intend to practice tomorrow as well.

Example

A 「明日も練習する？」 B 「ええ、そのつもり」

A: Will you practice tomorrow too? B: Yeah, that's the plan.

Notes

"Sono tsumori" is used to affirm that the speaker intends to do what has just been mentioned. "Sono" refers back to the previous utterance, and "tsumori" means intention, plan, or what one has in mind. In the example, A asks whether B will practice tomorrow too. B does not need to repeat "ashita mo renshuu suru." By saying "ee, sono tsumori," B confirms that this is indeed the plan. The expression can sound casual and matter-of-fact, but depending on the tone, it can also imply reassurance, mild insistence, or a response to doubt.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

intention

confirming a plan

confirmation response

agreement

acceptance

Tags EN

immediate grammar

intention expression

plan expression

confirmation response

ellipsis

context-dependent expression

spoken language

I was going to

そのつもりだった

Sono tsumori datta

I was going to

Variants

- そのつもりだった

I was going to

- そうするつもりだった

I meant to

- やるつもりだった

I intended to

- 行くつもりだった

I had planned to

- 行くつもりだったけど

I was about to, but...

Adjusted Expression

A 「行く^い予定^{よてい}だったのですか？」 B 「はい、行く^い予定^{よてい}でしたが、事情^{じじょう}があって
行^いけませんでした」

A: Were you planning to go? B: Yes, I had planned to go, but because of the circumstances, I was not able to.

Example

A 「行くつもりだったの？」 B 「行くつもりだったけど、行^いけなかった」

A: Were you going to go? B: I was going to, but I couldn't.

Notes

"Tsumori datta" expresses a past intention, plan, or expectation that did not necessarily become reality. "Tsumori" means intention or plan, and "datta" marks it as past. In the example, B says "iku tsumori datta kedo, ikenakatta," meaning that B intended to go, but was not able to. The important point is that the expression presents the intention as something that existed before the result became known. It often appears with "kedo," because the speaker is explaining why the intended action did not happen. "Sono tsumori datta" can also refer back to a plan or action already mentioned, just as "sono tsumori" does in the present. When asking another person, as in "iku tsumori datta no?", the speaker is asking about that person's past intention.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

past intention

unrealized plan

explanation

excuse

regret

Tags EN

immediate grammar

intention expression

past intention

unrealized plan

excuse expression

regret

spoken language

What do you mean?

どういうこと？

Dou iu koto?

What do you mean?

Variants

- どういうこと？

What do you mean?

- どういう意味？

What does that mean?

- どういうことなの？

What is that supposed to mean?

- どういうことだろう？

What are you talking about?

- どういうことなんでしょう？

What happened?

- 何があったの？

What is going on?

Adjusted Expression

A 「予定は中止になりました」 B 「すみません、それはどういうことですか。
理由を説明していただけませんか」

A: The plan has been canceled. B: Excuse me, what does that mean?
Could you explain the reason?

Example

A 「予定は、中止」 B 「え、どういうこと？」

A: The plan is canceled. B: Huh? What do you mean?

Notes

"Dou iu koto?" is a casual expression used when the speaker does not understand the meaning, reason, or situation behind what has just been said. Literally, it asks "what kind of thing?", but in conversation it functions as "What do you mean?", "What is going on?", or "What happened?" depending on the context. In the example, A suddenly says that the plan is canceled. B first reacts with "e," showing surprise, and then asks "dou iu koto?" B is not only asking for the dictionary meaning of the word "canceled." B is asking for the circumstances and explanation behind the sudden statement. Compared with "dou iu imi?", which focuses more on the meaning of a word or statement, "dou iu koto?" often reaches toward the situation behind it.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

confirmation

question

request for explanation

checking the situation

request for understanding

Tags EN

immediate grammar

question expression

request for explanation

checking the situation

reaction expression

context-dependent expression

spoken language

More or less

だいたい

Daitai

More or less

Variants

- だいたい
more or less
- ほとんど
mostly
- おおよそ
almost
- ほぼ
roughly
- だいたい 大体
about
- nearly

Adjusted Expression

A 「宿題しゅくだいは終わりましたか？」 B 「はい、ほぼ完了かんりょうしましたが、まだ少しすこ残っのこています」

A: Have you finished your homework? B: Yes, most of it is done, but a little is still left.

Example

A 「^{しゅくだい}宿題は、^お終わった？」 B 「うん、だいたい」

A: Did you finish your homework? B: Yeah, more or less.

Notes

"Daitai" is used to give an approximate answer without making it exact. It can mean "roughly," "mostly," "more or less," or "about," depending on the context. In this example, A asks whether the homework is finished. B answers only "un, daitai," leaving out the rest of the sentence. The answer means that most of it is done, but it also implies that it may not be completely finished. This is why "daitai" can be convenient but also slightly risky. It gives a positive answer while leaving room for incompleteness. The meaning emerges from the question, the situation, and what kind of completion is being asked about.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

approximation

rough estimate

implying incompleteness

degree expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

approximation expression

degree expression

incompleteness

softening expression

confirmation response

spoken language

Oh well

ま、いっか

Ma, ikka

Oh well

Variants

- ま、いっか

Oh well

- まあ、いっか

Never mind

- ま、いいか

It's okay

- まあ、いいか

It's fine

- それでいいか

That'll do

- しかたないか

I guess that's fine

Adjusted Expression

A 「今日はカレーです」 B 「今日もカレーなのですね。少し意外ですが、それでかまいません」

A: It's curry today. B: Curry again today? That is a little unexpected, but that is fine.

Example

A 「^{きょう}今日は^{かれー}カレーよ」 B 「え、^{きょう}今日も？ま、いっか」

A: It's curry today. B: Oh, again today? Oh well.

Notes

"Ma, ikka" is a casual expression used when the speaker decides to accept a situation lightly, even though it may not be exactly what they expected or wanted. "Ma" softens the speaker's reaction, like "well" or "oh well," and "ikka" comes from "ii ka," meaning something like "I guess it's okay." In the example, B is a little surprised or disappointed that the meal is curry again, but does not make a serious complaint. By saying "ma, ikka," B adjusts their own feeling and lets the matter pass. The expression often carries compromise, resignation, or self-persuasion, but in a light tone. It is not a formal acceptance; it is a small spoken act of settling the matter for the moment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

compromise resignation self-acceptance light acceptance

Tags EN

immediate grammar compromise expression resignation expression self-acceptance
acceptance expression emotional adjustment spoken language

Can I borrow it?

か
貸して、...

Kashite, ...

Can I borrow it?

Variants

- か
貸して
Can I borrow it?
- ちょっとか
貸して
Let me borrow it
- か
貸してくれる？
Could you lend it to me?
- か
貸してよ
Lend it to me
- か
貸してください
Please lend it to me

Adjusted Expression

A 「これを少し貸していただけませんか」 B 「はい、お貸しします」

A: Could you lend this to me for a little while? B: Yes, I can lend it to you.

Example

A 「これ、か
貸して」 B 「か
貸してあげるよ」

A: Can I borrow this? B: Sure, I'll lend it to you.

Notes

"Kashite" is a casual te-form request used when the speaker wants to borrow something or use it temporarily. It comes from "kasu," meaning "to lend." From the speaker's point of view, the natural English translation is often "Can I borrow this?" rather than the literal "Lend me this." In the example, A says "kore, kashite," asking to borrow the item in front of them. B answers "kashite ageru yo," meaning that B will lend it. The expression is short and convenient among close people, but because it directly asks for access to someone else's possession, it can sound too casual or pushy if the relationship is not close. Adding "chotto" or using "kashite kuremasen ka" softens the request.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

request

borrowing

temporary use

intimacy

casualness

Tags EN

immediate grammar

request expression

borrowing expression

temporary use

te-form request

context-dependent expression

spoken language

Seriously?

まじ
マジ

Maji

Seriously?

Variants

- まじ
マジ

Seriously?

- まじで

For real?

- まじ？

Really?

- ほんとう
本当に？

Are you serious?

- ほんき
本気で？

No kidding

Adjusted Expression

A 「明日、試験があります」 B 「ほんとう
本当にですか」

A: There is an exam tomorrow. B: Is that true?

Example

A 「明日、試験、あるよ」 B 「まじ？」

A: There's an exam tomorrow. B: Seriously?

Notes

"Maji" is a casual expression used to show surprise, disbelief, confirmation, or seriousness. In the example, B says only "maji?" after hearing that there is an exam tomorrow. The word itself does not spell out the whole question, but the situation supplies the meaning: "Is that really true?" or "Are you serious?" The expression is short and immediate, so it works well as a quick reaction to unexpected information. It is often associated with youth language, but it is also widely used in casual speech. In more polite situations, expressions such as "hontou desu ka" or "hontou ni sou nan desu ka" are more appropriate.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

surprise confirmation disbelief intimacy

Tags EN

immediate grammar surprise expression confirmation expression disbelief
reaction expression youth slang spoken language

That's just too much

いくらなんでも...

Ikura nan demo...

That's just too much

Variants

- いくらなんでも
That's just too much
- いくらなんでもさ
Come on, seriously
- いくらなんでもそれは
No matter how you look at it
- いくらなんでもひどい
This is going too far
- いくらなんでも、それはない
That's unacceptable

Adjusted Expression

いくらなんでも、それは許容^{きょよう}できないとおも^{おも}います。

No matter how you look at it, I do not think that is acceptable.

Example

いくらなんでも、それはないんじゃない？

Come on, that's just too much, don't you think?

Notes

"Ikura nan demo" is used when the speaker feels that something goes beyond what can be accepted, no matter what circumstances are considered. Grammatically, it creates a concessive frame, something like "no matter how much" or "even taking that into account." In conversation, however, it often works as a preface to criticism or rejection. In the example, "ikura nan demo, sore wa nai n ja nai?" means that even if there may be some reason or background, the speaker still finds it unacceptable. The expression can also trail off as "ikura nan demo...", leaving the criticism unstated. In that case, meanings such as "that's too much," "that's unreasonable," or "that goes too far" emerge from the situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

surprise criticism rejection limit of acceptance refusal to agree

Tags EN

immediate grammar emotional expression criticism expression rejection expression
limit of acceptance unfinished utterance spoken language

Oh, that time

あのときね

Ano toki ne

Oh, that time

Variants

- あのときね
Oh, that time
- あのときさ
Back then, right?
- あのときはね
At that time, remember?
- ああ、あのときね
Oh, you mean that time
- あのときのことね
That time, yes

Adjusted Expression

A 「けがをしたのですか？」 B 「はい、^{えき}駅でけがをしました」 A 「ああ、その
ときのことですね」

A: Did you get hurt? B: Yes, I got hurt at the station. A: Oh, you mean that
time.

Example

A 「けがしたの？」 B 「うん、^{えき}駅で」 A 「ああ、あのときね」

A: Did you get hurt? B: Yeah, at the station. A: Oh, that time.

Notes

"Ano toki ne" is used when the speaker recalls a past event as something shared with the listener. "Ano" points to something that both speaker and listener are expected to know or remember, and "toki" means "time" or "occasion." The final "ne" gives the expression a feeling of checking or sharing that memory with the listener. In the example, B only says "at the station," but A immediately responds with "aa, ano toki ne." Before hearing a full explanation, A matches the hint with a remembered event. The expression does not simply state a past time. It brings a shared memory into the conversation and confirms it with the other person.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

recollection

matching a memory

topic introduction

checking shared memory

intimacy

Tags EN

immediate grammar

recollection expression

memory matching

topic introduction

checking shared memory

intimacy expression

spoken language

Starting now

これから

Kore kara

Starting now

Variants

- これから
starting now
- ^{いま}今から
from now
- ここから
from here
- これからやる
I'm about to start
- これから^{はじ}始める
I'll do it now

Adjusted Expression

A 「いつやるのですか？」 B 「これから^{はじ}始めます」

A: When are you going to do it? B: I am going to start now.

Example

A 「ねえ、いつやるの？」 B 「これから」

A: Hey, when are you going to do it? B: Now. I'm about to start.

Notes

"Kore kara" marks the present moment as the starting point for what comes next. "Kore" points to the current situation or time, and "kara" marks it as the point of departure. In the example, A asks "When are you going to do it?" and B answers only "kore kara." The fuller form would be something like "kore kara yaru" or "kore kara hajimeru," but the missing action is supplied by the previous question. "Kore kara" does not always mean "right this second," but in this example it means that the speaker is about to start now or very soon. The expression draws a boundary at the present moment and moves the conversation toward the next action.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

beginning intention future temporal boundary starting an action

Tags EN

immediate grammar time expression starting expression statement of intent
temporal boundary context shift spoken language

After that

あれから

Are kara

After that

Variants

- あれから
after that
- それから
since then
- その後^{あと}
afterwards
- あの後^{あと}
what happened after that
- あれからどうした
since that happened

Adjusted Expression

A 「きのう、あの出来事^{できごと}の後^{あと}、どうになりましたか？」 B 「財布^{さいふ}も、カード^{かーど}も、現金^{げんきん}も、全部^{ぜんぶ}いっしょ^みに見つかりました」

A: What happened after that incident yesterday? B: My wallet, card, and cash were all found together.

Example

A 「きのう、あれから、どうした？」 B 「うん、財布^{さいふ}も、カード^{かーど}も、現金^{げんきん}も、全部^{ぜんぶ}、いっしょ^みに見つかったよ」

A: So, what happened after that yesterday? B: Yeah, my wallet, card, and cash were all found together.

Notes

"Are kara" refers to the time after a past event or situation that is shared by the speaker and listener. "Are" points to something already known between them, and "kara" marks it as the starting point in time. In the example, A asks "kinou, are kara, dou shita?" The event referred to by "are" is not stated explicitly, but both A and B understand what happened yesterday. Because that shared memory is already available, A can simply say "are kara" and ask what happened afterward. The expression is not only a way to recall the past. It moves the conversation from a shared past event to the following development.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

recollection

checking what followed

shared memory

topic introduction

asking about what happened afterward

Tags EN

immediate grammar

recollection expression

checking what followed

shared memory

topic introduction

time expression

spoken language

I don't care anymore

もう、どうでもいい

Mou, dou demo ii

I don't care anymore

Variants

- もう、どうでもいい
I don't care anymore
- もう、どうでもよかった
I don't care about it anymore
- もう、どうでもいいや
I don't care either way anymore
- もう、どうでもいいよ
Whatever
- もう、なんでもいい
It doesn't matter to me anymore

Adjusted Expression

A 「お好きなものを買ってきましょうね」 B 「もう、何を選んでもかまいません。あまり気にしないことにします」

A: Let's buy what you like. B: At this point, anything is fine. I will stop worrying about it.

Example

A 「お好きなものを買ってきましょうね」 B 「もう、どうでもいい」

A: Let's buy what you like. B: I don't care anymore.

Notes

"Mou, dou demo ii" is used when the speaker lets go of interest, expectation, or concern about something. "Mou" suggests that the speaker has reached this point after some process, such as frustration, fatigue, disappointment, or repeated thinking. "Dou demo ii" literally means that any way would be fine, but in this example it does not sound like flexible acceptance. It sounds more like the speaker no longer has the energy or desire to care. A says, "Let's buy what you like," but B answers, "I don't care anymore." This response can imply emotional withdrawal rather than a simple lack of preference. Compared with "ma, ikka," which often sounds like light acceptance, "mou, dou demo ii" can sound more resigned, disappointed, or detached.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

resignation giving up loss of interest disappointment emotional shutdown

Tags EN

immediate grammar resignation expression giving-up expression loss of interest
disappointment emotional adjustment spoken language

To give you the conclusion first

けつろん い
結論から言えば

Ketsuron kara ieba

To give you the conclusion first

Variants

- けつろん い
結論から言えば

To give you the conclusion first

- けつろん い
結論から言うと

To start with the conclusion

- けつろん い
結論だけ言えば

Bottom line

- ひとつこと い
一言で言えば

To sum it up

- たんてき い
端的に言えば

To make a long story short

Adjusted Expression

A 「^{さき}先に^{けつろん}結論を^{もう}申し上げますと、それは^あ実現できないということです」 B 「では、これまでの話は^{はなし}何^{なん}だったのですか」

A: To state the conclusion first, that means it cannot be done. B: Then what was all the discussion up to now about?

Example

A 「^{けつろん}結論^いから言えば、それはできないということ」 B 「じゃ、これまでは何^{なん}だったの？」

A: Bottom line, it means it can't be done. B: Then what was all this about?

Notes

"Ketsuron kara ieba" is used when the speaker presents the conclusion or main judgment before giving the reasons or background. "Ketsuron" means the conclusion, and "kara ieba" frames that conclusion as the starting point of the explanation. In the example, A first says "ketsuron kara ieba" and then states that it cannot be done. The detailed explanation is not given first. Instead, the result that matters most to the listener comes first. That is why B reacts by asking, "Then what was all this about?" The phrase can be neutral, but in conversation it often prepares the listener for an unfavorable result or a firm judgment. Its immediate quality lies in reorganizing the explanation in real time so that the conclusion appears before the supporting details.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

presenting the main point

conclusion first

opening the explanation

adjusting the order of explanation

omitting the preface

Tags EN

immediate grammar

discourse marker

conclusion first

main point first

order of explanation

framing expression

spoken language

To be honest

しょうじき
正直、

Shoujiki

To be honest

Variants

- しょうじき
正直

To be honest

- しょうじき い
正直に言う

Honestly

- しょうじき い
正直に言えば

Honestly speaking

- しょうじき
正直なところ

To be frank

- しょうじき はなし
正直な話

In all honesty

Adjusted Expression

A 「しょうじき い
正直に言いますと、あまり好きではありません」 B 「そうなのですか」

A: To be honest, I do not really like it. B: Is that so?

Example

A 「しょうじき す
正直、あまり好きじゃない」 B 「え、そうなの？」

A: To be honest, I don't really like it. B: Oh, really?

Notes

"Shoujiki" is used before the speaker says an honest feeling, frank opinion, or something slightly difficult to say. In the example, A does not simply say "I don't really like it." A first says "shoujiki," placing the following statement in the frame of honesty or frankness. The word does not change the grammar of the main clause, but it changes how the utterance is heard. It signals that the speaker is lowering the usual social filter and saying what they really think. Because of this, the listener may expect something direct or possibly unfavorable. Expressions such as "shoujiki ni iu to" and "shoujiki na tokoro" work in a similar way as preposed framing expressions.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

frankness

honest feeling

self-disclosure

saying something difficult

intimacy

Tags EN

immediate grammar

honest-feeling expression

frankness expression

self-disclosure

framing expression

extrasyntactic preposed phrase

spoken language

If I had to say

あえて^い言うなら

Aete iu nara

If I had to say

Variants

- あえて^い言うなら
If I had to say
- あえて^い言えば
If I had to put it that way
- あえて^い言うと
If I had to say it
- あえて^い言うならば
If I were forced to choose
- あえて^{ひと}一つ^い言うなら
If I had to name one thing

Adjusted Expression

A 「どちらが^す好きですか？」 B 「あえて^{もう}申し^あ上げるとすれば、どちらもあまり^す好きではありません」

A: Which one do you like? B: If I had to say, I do not really like either of them.

Example

A 「ど^すっちが好き？」 B 「あえて^い言うなら、どちらも^す好きじゃない」

A: Which do you like? B: If I had to say, I don't like either.

Notes

"Aete iu nara" is used when the speaker says something that they might otherwise avoid saying, or when they give an answer only under the condition that they must say something. "Aete" suggests doing something deliberately even though it may not be the natural or easiest choice. In the example, A asks which one B likes. B does not answer directly at first, but begins with "aete iu nara" and then says, "I don't like either." The phrase frames the answer as something said only if the speaker has to say it. It is therefore useful before a negative evaluation, a difficult opinion, or a reluctant answer. When both options are good and the speaker simply has to choose one, "dochira ka to ieba" sounds softer.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

frankness conditional statement saying something difficult evaluation
response to a forced choice

Tags EN

immediate grammar framing expression conditional statement frankness expression
evaluation expression extrasyntactic preposed phrase spoken language

Yeah, yeah

はいはい

Hai hai

Yeah, yeah

Variants

- はいはい
Yeah, yeah
- はいはい、わかりました
Okay, okay
- はいはい、わかりましたよ
Okay, okay, I got it
- はいはい、わかりましたよ、もう
Yeah, yeah, I understand
- はいはい、もうわかった
Yeah, yeah, I got it already

Adjusted Expression

A 「明日^{あした}こそ、やってください」 B 「はい、わかりました。明日^{あした}は必ず^{かなら}やりま
す」

A: Please make sure you do it tomorrow. B: Yes, I understand. I will
definitely do it tomorrow.

Example

A 「明日^{あした}こそ、やってよ」 B 「はいはい、わかりました」

A: Make sure you do it tomorrow. B: Yeah, yeah, I got it.

Notes

"Hai hai" repeats "hai," meaning "yes," but it does not always show sincere agreement. It can acknowledge what the other person said while also suggesting that the speaker has already heard enough, finds it troublesome, or wants to move on. In the example, A says, "Make sure you do it tomorrow," and B answers, "hai hai, wakarimashita." B is formally accepting the request, but the repetition gives the response a slightly dismissive or reluctant tone. A sincere and polite response would be "hai, wakarimashita." A common scene is a child answering "hai hai" and a parent saying, "Say 'hai' only once." This shows that "hai hai" is not just a repeated yes. It can easily be heard as a sign that the speaker is brushing the other person off. English has similar cases. If a child answers with a drawn-out "Oh, yeah..." or speaks back with a dismissive tone, a parent might say, "Don't mouth off to me" or "Don't give me that attitude." In both languages, what causes trouble is not the literal meaning of the words, but the attitude that emerges through repetition, tone, and timing.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

response reluctant acceptance brushing off resignation mild resistance

Tags EN

immediate grammar response expression acceptance expression brushing off
reluctant acceptance repetition spoken language

And then, you know...

でね、

De ne

And then, you know...

Variants

- でね、
And then, you know...
- でさ、
So, you know...
- でさあ、
So, like...
- でねえ、
And you know what?
- それでね、
So, you see...

Adjusted Expression

A 「きのう、^か買い物^{もの}に行きました。それで、そこで^{だれ}誰^あに会^{おも}ったと思いますか」

A: Yesterday, I went shopping. Then, who do you think I met there?

Example

A 「きのう、^か買い物^{もの}に行ったの、でね、そこで、^{だれ}誰^あに会^{おも}ったと思う？」

A: Yesterday, I went shopping, and then, you know, guess who I met there?

Notes

"De ne" is a casual discourse marker used to continue a story while drawing the listener into the next part. "De" connects the previous event to what follows, and "ne" invites the listener's attention or shared involvement. In the example, the speaker first says that they went shopping yesterday, then uses "de ne" before moving to the more interesting part: "guess who I met there?" The expression does not simply connect clauses. It creates a small entrance into the next development of the story. In intimate conversation, it lets the speaker move forward while checking that the listener is still with them.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

continuing a story

introducing the next part

intimacy

drawing in the listener

sharing

Tags EN

immediate grammar

discourse marker

continuing a story

topic introduction

intimacy expression

checking shared attention

spoken language

But you know what?

それがさ、

Sore ga sa

But you know what?

Variants

- それがさ、
But you know what?
- それがさあ、
But then...
- それがね、
The thing is...
- それがねえ、
And here's the thing...
- ところがさ、
But surprisingly...

Adjusted Expression

A 「無理^{むり}だと思^{おも}っていたのですが、^{じっさい}実際にやってみたところ、^{あんがい}案外うまくいきました」 B 「そうなのですか」

A: I thought it would be impossible, but when I actually tried it, it went surprisingly well. B: Is that so?

Example

A 「無理^{むり}だって思^{おも}ってたんだけど、それがさ、やってみたら案^{あん}外^{がい}うまくいったんだよね」 B 「え、ほんとに？」

A: I thought it was impossible, but you know what? When I tried it, it actually went surprisingly well. B: Oh, really?

Notes

"Sore ga sa" is a casual discourse marker used when the speaker introduces a development that differs from what was just expected or assumed. "Sore" refers back to the previous situation or topic, while "ga" opens a contrastive turn, and "sa" draws the listener into the speaker's story. In the example, the speaker first says that they thought it would be impossible. Then "sore ga sa" introduces the unexpected result: when they tried it, it went surprisingly well. This is not a neutral topic shift. It carries the speaker's attitude, something like "Listen, it turned out differently from what I expected." The expression changes the direction of the story in real time and invites the listener's reaction.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

unexpected development

introducing the next part

shifting the premise

drawing in the listener

intimacy

Tags EN

immediate grammar

discourse marker

unexpectedness

premise shift

topic introduction

intimacy expression

spoken language

We'll talk about that later

それはまたあとで、

Sore wa mata ato de

We'll talk about that later

Variants

- それはまたあとで

We'll talk about that later

- それはまた^{あと}後でね

Let's talk about that later

- その話^{はなし}はまた^{あと}後で

Let's leave that for later

- それについてはまた^{あと}後で

We'll get to that later

- ^{あと}後で^{はな}話そう

I'll explain that later

Adjusted Expression

A 「どのような^{もんだい}問題^{しけん}が試験^でに出るのですか」 B 「それについては、また^{あと}後ほどお話し^{はな}します」

A: What kind of questions will be on the exam? B: I will talk about that later.

Example

A 「どんな^{もんだい}問題^{しけん}が試験^でに出るんですか」 B 「それはまたあとで」

A: What kind of questions will be on the exam? B: We'll talk about that later.

Notes

"Sore wa mata ato de" is used when the speaker postpones a topic instead of answering or explaining it immediately. "Sore" refers to the question or topic just mentioned, and "mata ato de" means that it will be dealt with later, not now. In the example, a student asks what kind of questions will be on the exam, but the teacher does not answer right away. By saying "sore wa mata ato de," the teacher delays the topic and keeps control of the flow of the lesson. The expression is not simply an introduction to a topic. It is a way of setting the topic aside for the moment. Its immediate quality lies in adjusting the order of topics in real time.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- postponing a topic
- discourse management
- delaying an answer
- topic shift
- situational adjustment

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- discourse marker
- postponing a topic
- discourse management
- delaying an answer
- situational adjustment
- spoken language

Colophon

Title	An Expression A Day
Author	Hilofumi Yamamoto, Ph.D.
Range	No. 301-400 / 100 entries
License	Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)
Source	Generated from AEAD JSON data.